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TEST BOOKLET SERIES

**Test Code:
2202****TEST BOOKLET
GENERAL STUDIES
TEST – 2****B****Time Allowed : Two Hours****Maximum Marks : 200****INSTRUCTIONS**

1. IMMEDIATELY AFTER THE COMMENCEMENT OF THE EXAMINATION, YOU SHOULD CHECK THAT THIS TEST BOOKLET *DOES NOT* HAVE ANY UNPRINTED OR TORN OR MISSING PAGES OR ITEMS, ETC. IF SO, GET IT REPLACED BY A COMPLETE TEST BOOKLET.
2. ENCODE CLEARLY THE TEST BOOKLET SERIES CODE **A, B, C** OR **D** AS THE CASE MAY BE IN THE APPROPRIATE PLACE IN THE ANSWER SHEET.
3. You have to enter your Roll Number on the Test Booklet in the Box provided alongside this line. *DO NOT* write *anything else* on the Test Booklet.
4. This Test Booklet contains 100 items (questions). Each question is printed both in **Hindi** and **English**. Each item comprises four responses (answers). You will select the response which you want to mark on the Answer Sheet. In case you feel that there is more than one correct response, mark the response which you consider the best. In any case, choose **ONLY ONE** response for each item.
5. You have to mark all your responses **ONLY** on the separate Answer Sheet provided. See directions in the Answer sheet.
6. All items carry equal marks.
7. Before you proceed to mark in the Answer Sheet the response to various items in the Test Booklet, you have to fill in some particulars in the Answer Sheet as per instructions sent to you with your admission certificate.
8. After you have completed filling in all your responses on the Answer Sheet and examination has concluded, you should hand over to the Invigilator *only the Answer Sheet*. You are permitted to take away with you the Test Booklet.
9. Sheets for rough work are appended in the Test Booklet at the end.
10. **Penalty for wrong answers:**
THERE WILL BE PENALTY FOR WRONG ANSWERS MARKED BY A CANDIDATE IN THE OBJECTIVE TYPE QUESTION PAPERS.
 - (i) There are four alternatives for the answer to every question. For each question for which a wrong answer has been given by the candidate, **One-Third** of the marks assigned to that question will be deducted as penalty.
 - (ii) If a candidate gives more than one answer, it will be treated as a **wrong answer** even if one of the given answers happens to be correct and there will be same penalty as above to that question.
 - (iii) If a question is left blank, i.e., no answer is given by the candidate, there will be no **penalty** for that question.

@UPSC_SUCCESS_TIME1**DO NOT OPEN THIS TEST BOOKLET UNTIL YOU ARE ASKED TO DO SO***Note:* Hindi version of the instructions is printed on the front cover of this Booklet.

1. Consider the following statements regarding District Planning Committee:

1. It consolidates the plans prepared by Panchayats and Municipalities in the district.
2. The Governor has the power to make provisions with respect to the composition of such committees.
3. As per the 74th Amendment Act, four-fifths of its members are elected by indirect election.

Which of the statements given above are correct:

- (a) 1 and 2 only (b) 1 and 3 only
(c) 2 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

2. Consider the following statements regarding features of Lokpal in India as given under Lokpal and Lokayuktas Act, 2013:

1. Institutions which are financed fully or partly by the Government and institutions aided by the Government are under the jurisdiction of Lokpal.
2. The Lokpal has the power of superintendence and direction over CBI for cases referred to it by the Lokpal.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

3. Consider the following statements:

1. The nomination of a candidate for election to the office of President must be subscribed by at least 100 electors as proposers and 50 electors as seconders.
2. Every candidate for election to the office of President has to make a security deposit of ₹15,000 in the Reserve Bank of India.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

4. Who of the following is the chief executive head of the State?

- (a) Governor
(b) Chief Minister
(c) President
(d) Speaker of the Legislative Assembly

5. Consider the following statements regarding the Central Administrative Tribunal (CAT):

1. The CAT exercises original jurisdiction in relation to recruitment and all service matters of public servants covered by it.
2. The CAT is bound by the procedure laid down in the Civil Procedure Code of 1908.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
(b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2
(d) Neither 1 nor 2

6. With reference to food fortification, consider the following statements:

1. The '+F' logo is used to identify fortified foods.
2. It is a food-based approach which has a high benefit-to-cost ratio.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
(b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2
(d) Neither 1 nor 2

7. With reference to the Public Accounts Committee, consider the following statements:

1. It was established as a result of the Montagu-Chelmsford Reforms.
2. The committee has the power to summon the Governor of the Reserve Bank of India.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

8. Consider the following statements:

1. Statutory grants are given to the States on the recommendation of the Finance Commission.
2. Surcharge levied by the Parliament under Article 271 of the Constitution of India can not be levied on Goods and Services Tax (GST).

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

9. With reference to Sixth Schedule Areas, consider the following statements:

1. The tribal areas of Assam, Manipur, Tripura and Mizoram are mentioned under this schedule.
2. The acts of Parliament or the State Legislatures do not apply to autonomous districts and autonomous regions, established under this schedule, or apply with specified modifications and exceptions.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

10. Consider the following statements with respect to the 'No-Confidence Motion':

1. It is exclusively mentioned under the Article 75 of Indian Constitution.
2. J.B. Kripalani moved the first-ever no-confidence motion in 1971 against the then Indira Gandhi Government.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

11. With reference to Family Courts, consider the following statements:

1. State Governments have to set up a Family Court in every city or town with a population exceeding one million.
2. The parties to a dispute before a Family Court are entitled to be represented by a legal practitioner.

3. The parties can appeal against a judgement only once at the concerned High Court.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 1 and 3 only
(c) 2 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

12. With reference to the Counter-cyclical Fiscal Policy Stance during an economic boom, consider the following statements:

1. In an expansionary fiscal policy both government expenditure and taxes are increased.
2. Contractionary fiscal policy helps the government to moderate the economic boom in an economy.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

13. With reference to the Swachh Bharat Mission-Rural and Urban (SBM-R and SBM-U), consider the following statements:

1. SBM-U has achieved its target of 100% scientific processing of the Municipal Solid Waste (MSW).
2. Phase II of SBM-R is focusing on Open Defecation Free (ODF) sustainability and Solid & Liquid Waste Management (SLWM).

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

14. With reference to Deposit Insurance and Credit Guarantee Corporation (DICGC), consider the following statements:

1. The deposit insurance provided by DICGC in case of bank failure is ₹1 lakh per account only.
2. Deposit Insurance and Credit Guarantee Corporation is a fully owned subsidiary of RBI.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

15. Consider the following statements about Interest Equalization Scheme (IES):

1. The scheme aims for export promotion.
2. The scheme is being implemented by Export-Import Bank of India.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

16. In the context of Cryogenic Rocket Engine, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. It uses liquid hydrogen as the fuel.
2. It provides more thrust for every kilogram of propellant burnt as compared to solid and liquid propellants in rocket.
3. ISRO has developed an indigenous cryogenic engine to be used in GSLV.

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

- (a) 1 only (b) 1 and 2 only
(c) 1, 2 and 3 (d) None of the above

17. With reference to the Vice-President, which of the following statements are **NOT** correct?

1. The office of the Vice-President in India is modelled on the lines of the American Vice-President.
2. The Vice-President is accorded the third rank next to the President and the Prime Minister in the official warrant of precedence.
3. The Vice-President is elected by the members of an electoral college consisting of the elected members of both Houses of Parliament.
4. The election of a person as Vice-President cannot be challenged on the ground that the electoral college was incomplete.

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

- (a) 1 and 4 only (b) 1, 3 and 4 only
(c) 2 and 3 only (d) 1, 2, 3 and 4

18. Consider the following statements.

1. The term of the Chief Minister is not fixed and he holds office during the pleasure of the Governor.
2. The salary and allowances of the Chief Minister are determined by the Parliament.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
(b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2
(d) Neither 1 nor 2

19. Consider the following statements:

1. A Non-Governmental Organisation (NGO) indirectly financed by the government does not come under the ambit of the Right to Information Act.
2. The Right to Information Act, 2005 requires every public authority to computerize its records.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
(b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2
(d) Neither 1 nor 2

20. With reference to the Law Commission, consider the following statements:

1. A retired Supreme Court judge or Chief Justice of a High Court heads the Commission.
2. It is a non statutory advisory body.
3. It has a fixed term of five years.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 and 2 only
(b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1, 2 and 3
(d) 1 only

21. Regarding the disqualifications of the Member of Parliament, consider the following statements:

1. Detention of a person under a preventive detention law can be a ground to disqualify a Member of the Parliament.
2. Disqualification on ground of defection are given under the provisions of the Tenth Schedule of the Constitution.
3. For both Rajya Sabha and the Lok Sabha, Speaker of the Lok Sabha decides the disqualification, in case of defection.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) 3 only (d) None of the above

22. Consider the following statements:

1. The first historical reference to census in India can be found in Kautilya's Arthashastra.
2. The first synchronous census in India was held in 1881.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

23. Consider the following statements regarding the Chief Election Commissioner (CEC):

1. The CEC is appointed by the President of India.
2. The CEC can resign anytime or can be removed even before the expiry of his/her term.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

24. With reference to the Solow-Swan Model of Economic Growth, consider the following statements:

1. This model is the neoclassical model of economic growth.
2. According to this model, factors responsible for economic growth are- Labour, Capital and Technology.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

25. EDISON Alliance, launched by World Economic Forum aims to address:

- (a) Counterfeit currency
(b) Dark web
(c) Digital inequalities
(d) Risks in cross border investments

26. Consider the following statements about the Extinction Rebellion movement:

1. It aims to gather momentum for a response against climate emergency.
2. It is an initiative of the UN Framework Convention for Climate Change.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

27. With reference to recently launched NIRVIK Scheme, consider the following statements:

1. The scheme is an insurance cover guarantee for exporters.
2. The Export Credit Guarantee Corporation of India (ECGC) has introduced the scheme.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

28. As head of the State Council of Ministers which among the following power(s) is/are enjoyed by the Chief Minister?

1. He allocates and reshuffles the portfolios among ministers on the advice of the Governor.
2. He can ask a minister to resign or advise the Governor to dismiss him in case of a difference of opinion.
3. He can bring about the collapse of the Council of Ministers by resigning from office.

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) 1 and 3 only (d) 2 and 3 only

29. In which of the following cases, High Courts enjoy original jurisdiction in India?

1. Disputes relating to the election of members of Parliament.
2. Enforcement of fundamental rights of citizens.
3. Matters of marriage and divorce.

Select the correct answer using codes below:

- (a) 1 and 2 (b) 2 and 3
(c) 1 and 3 (d) 1, 2 and 3

30. Consider the following statements about the status of National Political Party:

1. No political party from the North Eastern Region has National Political Party status.
2. The Election Commission has the power to recognize as well as de-register a political party.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

31. With reference to Schedules of the Indian constitution, consider the following statements:

1. Third Schedule contains the provisions of oaths and affirmations.
2. Provisions related to the administration of the tribal areas of Tripura are given in the fifth schedule.
3. By enactment of the 21st Amendment Act of 1967, Sindhi was recognised as constitutional language provided in the eighth schedule.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

- (a) 1 and 2 only
(b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only
(d) 1, 2 and 3

32. Which of the following statements is/are correct about Judicial Review?

1. The power of judicial review can be curtailed by a Constitutional amendment.
2. The phrase 'Judicial Review' has nowhere been used in the Constitution.

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

33. With reference to National Means Cum-Merit Scholarship Scheme (NMMSS), consider the following statements:

1. It is a scheme by the Ministry of Minority Affairs with the objective of reducing drop outs.
2. The students studying in "Kendriya Vidyalaya and "Jawahar Navodaya Vidyalayas" are not entitled to get scholarships under this scheme.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

34. Consider the following statements about public expenditure on social sector:

1. The expenditure on social services as a proportion of GDP has been decreasing since the last two fiscals.
2. Expenditure on health remains the largest constituent of the total social sector spending by the government.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

35. India has trade surplus with which of the following countries:

1. United States of America (USA)
2. United Arab Emirates
3. Hong Kong
4. Singapore

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

- (a) 1 and 2 only (b) 1, 2 and 3 only
(c) 1, 3 and 4 only (d) 1, 2, 3 and 4

36. Which of the following role/s is/are **NOT** performed by the Prime Minister?

1. He is the chief spokesman of the Union government.
2. He is the political head of the services.
3. He summons the joint sitting of both the Houses of Parliament.
4. He is the chairman of the National Water Resources Council.

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

- (a) 1 and 3 only (b) 3 only
(c) 2 and 4 only (d) 2, 3 and 4 only

37. Consider the following statements about Inner Line Permit (ILP):

1. The system of ILP is applicable in Assam, Meghalaya, Arunachal Pradesh and Nagaland.
2. The ILP is issued by the Ministry of Home Affairs.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
(b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2
(d) Neither 1 nor 2

38. Consider the following statements about the Central Employment Guarantee Council:

1. The Central Employment Guarantee Council has been constituted under the Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act (MGNREGA), 2005.
2. The Minister of Rural Development is the Chairman of the council.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
(b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2
(d) Neither 1 nor 2

39. With reference to the Committee of privileges, consider the following statements:

1. The committee of privileges is a 22 member body with 7 members from Rajya Sabha and 15 members from the Lok Sabha.
2. The Chairman nominates the respective members from each House of Parliament and is also the head of such committee.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

40. If any question arises whether a matter falls within the Governor's discretion or not, the decision of the

- (a) Chief Justice of the High Court is final.
(b) Governor is final.
(c) President is final.
(d) Council of Ministers is final.

41. The recommendation to constitute Bank Boards Bureau was given by which of the following committees?

- (a) Raghuram Rajan Committee
(b) PJ Nayak Committee
(c) Narsimhan Committee
(d) Uday Kotak Committee

42. Which of the following organizations has launched the Saksham portal and Seaweed mission?

- (a) Technology Information, Forecasting and Assessment Council (TIFAC)
(b) Ministry of Agriculture and Farmers Welfare
(c) Khadi Village Industry Commission (KVIC)
(d) Department of Fisheries

43. Which among the following has the right to determine the strength of a High Court?

- (a) President of India
(b) Chief Justice of India
(c) Union Minister of Law and Justice
(d) Supreme Court Collegium

44. With reference to provisions as to Ministers in the Centre, which among the following statements is **NOT** correct?

- (a) The Ministers shall hold office during the pleasure of the Prime Minister.
- (b) The Council of Ministers shall be collectively responsible to the Lok Sabha.
- (c) The President shall administer the oaths of office and secrecy to a Minister.
- (d) The salaries and allowances of Ministers shall be determined by the Parliament.

45. With reference to Municipal Corporations in India, consider the following statements:

1. The Municipal Commissioner heads the Municipal Council.
2. The decisions taken by the Municipal Council are implemented by the Mayor.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

46. Consider the following statements:

1. 42nd Constitutional Amendment Act made the advice of the council of ministers binding on the President.
2. A minister who is a member of one house cannot participate in the proceedings of the other house.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

47. With reference to the Advisory Jurisdiction of Supreme Court, consider the following statements:

1. The Supreme Court is bound to give its opinion on certain matters that are referred to it by the President.
2. The opinion given by the Supreme Court is not binding on the President.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

48. Consider the following statements about the Vembanad Lake:

1. This lake has been affected by the water hyacinth.
2. Below sea level rice cultivation is done around the lake.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

49. Consider the following statements:

1. All the Ministers in a State own joint responsibility to the Legislative Assembly for all their acts of omission and commission.
2. The Governor can remove a Minister at a time when the Council of Ministers enjoys the confidence of the Legislative Assembly.
3. There is no provision in the Constitution for the system of legal responsibility of the Minister in the States.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 and 2 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

50. With reference to the Attorney General of India, consider the following statements:

1. According to the provisions in the Constitution of India, he has to resign when the council of ministers resigns or is replaced.
2. His remuneration is equal to that of a judge of the Supreme Court.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

51. Consider the following statements:

1. 'Master of the Roster' refers to the privilege of the Chief Justice to constitute benches to hear cases.
2. Impeachment of Chief Justice of India can be initiated in the Lower House of the Parliament only.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

52. Who among the following is/are appointed by the Governor?

- (a) State Election Commissioner
(b) Advocate General of a State
(c) Chairman and Members of the State Public Service Commission
(d) All of the above

53. Consider the following pairs:

Cabinet Committee Function

- | | |
|------------------------------------|--|
| 1. Parliamentary Affairs Committee | – Directs and coordinates the governmental activities in the economic sphere |
| 2. Economic Affairs Committee | – Deals with all policy matters pertaining to domestic and foreign affairs |
| 3. Political Affairs Committee | – Looks after the progress of government business in the Parliament |

Which of the pairs given above is/are **NOT** correctly matched?

- (a) 1 and 2 only (b) 3 only
(c) 2 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

54. Kurubhas, a traditional sheep rearing community belong to which of the following states?

- (a) Kerala (b) Tamil Nadu
(c) Karnataka (d) Andhra Pradesh

55. Consider the following statements:

1. In Onion Routing, messages are encapsulated in layers of encryption.
2. Data present on the Dark Web can be accessed only by special softwares.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

56. With reference to the state legislature consider the following statements:

1. The Legislative Assembly is a continuing chamber as its normal term is five years from the date of its first meeting after the general elections.
2. In a Legislative Council, one-third of its members retire on the expiration of every second year.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

57. With reference to the United Nations High Commissioner for Refugees (UNHCR), consider the following statements:

1. The Global Trends Report is published by the UNHCR annually.
2. UNHCR was established to support the people who fled due to World War II.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

58. Regarding the Pro-Tem Speaker of the Lok Sabha, consider the following statements:

1. Pro-Tem Speaker presides over the first sitting of the Lok Sabha, administers the oath of office to the newly elected MPs.
2. Chief Justice of India himself administers the oath to the Speaker Pro-Tem.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

59. With reference to the Committee on Private Members' Bills and Resolutions, consider the following statements:

1. This committee is only found in the Lok Sabha and not in Rajya Sabha.
2. The committee is chaired by the Leader of Opposition of the concerned house.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

60. A member incurs disqualification from being a member of Parliament under the defection law if:

1. he voluntarily gives up the membership of the political party on whose ticket he is elected to the House.
2. he failed to lodge an account of his election expenses within the time.
3. any nominated member joins any political party after the expiry of six months.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) 1 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

61. Consider the following statements about Tholpavakoothu:

1. It is a form of rod puppetry of the Kerala state.
2. Its theme is based on Mahabharata.
3. It shows the fusion of Aryan Dravidian culture.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 and 2 only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 2 only (d) 3 only

62. With reference to the Padhna-Likhna Abhiyaan, consider the following statements:

1. This scheme targets adult illiterate aged 15 and above in both rural and urban areas.
2. The primary objective of Padhna Likhna Abhiyan is to impart functional literacy to 57 lakh adult illiterates for a period of one year - 2020 to 2021.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
(b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2
(d) Neither 1 nor 2

63. Consider the following statements about the Consumer Welfare Fund:

1. It has been set up under the Consumer Protection Act, 2019.
2. The Fund is being operated by the Department of Consumer Affairs.
3. Projects with local reach are given priority in case of funding.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) 2 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

64. Which of the following statements is/are **NOT** correct with reference to the Legislative Council?

1. The maximum strength of the Legislative Council is fixed at one-third of the total strength of the Legislative Assembly and the minimum strength is fixed at 40.
2. 5/6 of the total number of members of a Legislative Council are indirectly elected and 1/6 are nominated by the Governor.

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

- (a) 1 only
(b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2
(d) Neither 1 nor 2

65. With reference to initiatives by the International Solar Alliance, consider the following statements:

1. The World Solar Bank has been established to finance solar energy projects across the globe in any country.
2. Coalition for Sustainable Climate Action has been established for cooperation between members and non-member countries of ISA.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
(b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2
(d) Neither 1 nor 2

66. Which of the following species can be spotted around the Chilika Lake?

1. Dugongs
2. Irrawaddy Dolphin
3. Fishing Cat

Select the correct answer from the codes given below:

- (a) 2 and 3 only (b) 1 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 2 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

67. Consider the following statements about Bio Plastics:

1. Increased use of bio-plastics can raise the risk of deforestation.
2. Microorganisms are a probable source of bio-plastics.

Which of the following statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

68. With reference to the panel of chairpersons of Lok Sabha consider the following statements:

1. The Lok Sabha Speaker nominates from amongst the members a panel of not more than five chairpersons.
2. When a member of the panel of chairpersons is also not present, any other person as determined by the House acts as the Speaker.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

69. The Legislative Council of a state can only be abolished when:

- (a) The Legislative Assembly of the concerned state has passed an ordinary bill to that effect.
- (b) The Parliament has approved the resolution by a simple majority, which has already been passed by special majority in the concerned state assembly.
- (c) The President has approved a written report from the Governor of the concerned state.
- (d) A constitutional amendment act to that effect is passed by the Parliament with a special majority.

70. The Eastern Dedicated Freight Corridor (EDFC) project is part of India's Dedicated Freight Corridor (DFC) programme, which aims to create one of the world's biggest cargo operations. It passes through which of the following states?

1. Haryana 2. Assam
3. Jharkhand 4. Bihar
5. Odisha

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

- (a) 1, 2 and 4 only (b) 1, 3 and 4 only
(c) 1, 3 and 5 only (d) 2, 3 and 4 only

71. The Pagdi Sambhal Jatta Movement was started by which of the following leaders?

- (a) Bhagat Singh
- (b) Kartar Singh Sarabha
- (c) Ajit Singh
- (d) Lala Lajpat Rai

72. Consider the following statements about the Kinnal craft:

1. This craft had gained prominence due to the patronage from Maratha rulers.
2. This art can commonly be found in the area around Koppal.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

73. Which of the following is **NOT** true about the Private Members Bill?

- (a) It reflects the stand of the opposition party on public matters.
- (b) It has a lesser chance to be approved by the Parliament.
- (c) Its rejection by the House has no implication on the parliamentary confidence in the government or its resignation.
- (d) Its introduction in the House requires three months' notice.

74. Consider the following statements:

1. Both elected and nominated members of the Parliament can vote in the election of the President.
2. Among the Union Territories, only the elected members of the legislature of Delhi are entitled to vote in the election of the President.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

75. Which of the following statements is/are correct about Panchayats (Extension to Scheduled Areas) Act, 1996?

1. In Scheduled Areas, all seats of Chairpersons of Panchayats at all levels shall be reserved for the Scheduled Tribes.
2. The recommendations of the Gram Sabha or the Panchayats shall be mandatory for grant of prospecting licence or mining lease for minor minerals in the Scheduled Areas.

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

76. Consider the following statements regarding implementation of the 73rd Constitutional Amendment Act:

1. Being a Constitutional provision, the act is applicable to all the States of India.
2. The Parliament may direct that the provisions of this act shall apply to any Union Territory subject to such exceptions and modifications as it may specify.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

77. A parliamentary committee means a committee that

1. is appointed or elected by the House or nominated by the Speaker/Chairman.
2. works under the direction of the Speaker/Chairman.
3. presents its report to the House or the Speaker/Chairman.
4. has a secretariat provided by the Lok Sabha/Rajya Sabha.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

- (a) 1, 2 and 3 only
- (b) 3 and 4 only
- (c) 2, 3 and 4 only
- (d) 1, 2, 3 and 4

78. Consider the following statements:

1. Third generation biofuels are derived from industrial waste.
2. Indian sugarcane is considered the best raw material for production of biofuel due to its higher yield of ethanol.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

79. Consider the following statements:

1. Shortwave radio frequencies are used for long distance transmission.
2. Shortwave radio frequencies can get reflected from the ionosphere.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

80. The '100 × 100 × 100' programme seen in the news is related to which of the following?

- (a) Tuberculosis (TB) control program
- (b) Improving startup ecosystem
- (c) Improving the enrollment and retention of students in secondary education
- (d) Universal health coverage initiative

81. With reference to the Central Information Commission, consider the following statements:

1. The Chief Information Commissioner is not eligible for reappointment, once the tenure is over.
2. The Right to Information Act, 2005 was not applicable in the state of Jammu and Kashmir, prior to the reorganization in 2019.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

82. Consider the following statements:

1. Meghalaya does not have special provisions under Article 371 A-J of the Constitution of India.
2. Article 371-F also mentions the minimum number of members in the Sikkim Legislative Assembly.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

83. With reference to Public Interest Litigation, consider the following statements:

1. PIL is an exception to the rule of locus standi.
2. A PIL can be filed for an issue related to admission in the educational institution.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

84. Consider the following statements:

1. An ordinance can be issued by the President on subjects on which the Parliament can legislate including Constitutional amendments.
2. In Cooper case (1970), the Supreme Court held that the decision of the President to issue an ordinance can be questioned in a court of law.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

85. With reference to the United Nations High-Level Political Forum (HLPF) on Sustainable Development, consider the following statements:

1. It is under the ambit of the United Nations Economic and Social Council (ECOSOC).
2. It's establishment was mandated in 2012 by the Rio+20 outcome document.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

86. Consider the following statements about Treaty Shopping:

1. Treaty shopping is an investment strategy where domestic investors exploit loopholes in treaties of partner countries.
2. Treaty shopping results in a lower tax to GDP ratio.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

87. The Global AI Action Alliance (GAIA) has been launched by which of the following?

- (a) Organization for Economic Cooperation and Development
(b) Google
(c) European Union
(d) World Economic Forum

88. With reference to the Members of Parliament Local Area Development Scheme (MPLADS), consider the following statements:

1. Under the scheme funds are released in the form of grants-in-aid directly to the district authorities.
2. Elected Lok Sabha Members can recommend works in their constituencies, but the elected members of the Rajya Sabha can recommend works anywhere in the state from which they are elected.
3. Nominated Members of the Parliament cannot recommend works for implementation, anywhere in the country except the constituency in which they are registered as a voter.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

- (a) 1 and 2 only (b) 1 and 3 only
(c) 2 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

89. The state executive consists of

- (a) Chief Minister, Council of Ministers, and Advocate General
(b) Governor and Chief Minister
(c) Council of Ministers, Governor, and Chief Minister
(d) Governor, Chief Minister, Council of Ministers, and Advocate General

90. With reference to the Money Bill, consider the following statements:

1. Though imposition, remission and abolition of any tax is considered to be a part of Money Bill, regulation of any tax is a part of an ordinary bill.
2. Decision on whether a bill is a Money Bill or not, is taken by the speaker of the Lok Sabha.
3. When a Money Bill is presented to the President for his assent, he cannot return it for reconsideration of the house.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

- (a) 1 and 2 only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

91. Recently in news, Thwaites glacier is often called the Doomsday Glacier because:

- (a) It is the source of many of the mainland European rivers.
(b) It contains enough water to raise the world sea level by more than half a metre.
(c) As it is growing in size it poses great risk to block the main sea lane of communication in the North Atlantic ocean.
(d) It is prone to avalanches and poses potential risks to habitats around it.

92. Matua Community is mainly found in which of the following states?

- (a) Jharkhand (b) Rajasthan
(c) West Bengal (d) Gujarat

93. With reference to the findings of the Bare Necessities Index, consider the following statements:

1. For the year 2018, the access to Bare necessities was minimum for West Bengal, Jharkhand and Tripura.
2. In rural India, the highest access to bare necessities in 2018 is recorded in Punjab, Sikkim, Goa and Delhi.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

94. With reference to the Pro-cyclical Fiscal Policy stance during a recession, consider the following statements:

1. The government decreases its expenditure and increases the tax rates.
2. Pro-cyclical Fiscal Policy stance during a recession can deepen the recession.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

95. With reference to the India Volatility Index (VIX), consider the following statements:

1. This index was circulated by the Bombay Stock Exchange (BSE).
2. It measures the degree of fluctuation that can be expected in the Indian equity stocks in BSE over the next 30 days.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

96. With reference to Scheduled Caste and Scheduled Tribe (SC/STs) (Prevention of Atrocities) Act, 1989, consider the following statements:

1. The act establishes special courts for trial of offences listed under the act.
2. The objective of the act is to prevent the atrocities against SC/STs by persons other than SC/STs.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

97. With reference to Lok Adalats, consider the following statements:

1. No appeal lies against the order of a Lok Adalat.
2. Only a case in the pre-litigation stage can be heard in Lok Adalats.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

98. With reference to the National Disaster Management Authority (NDMA), consider the following statements:

1. The Prime Minister is the ex-officio chairperson of the NDMA.
2. It works under the administrative control of the Union Ministry of Home Affairs.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
(b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2
(d) Neither 1 nor 2

99. With reference to Cooperative Societies, consider the following statements:

1. Right to form Cooperative Societies was made a fundamental right by the 97th Constitutional Amendment Act, 2011.
2. Cooperative Societies are mentioned in the Concurrent List of the Seventh Schedule of the Constitution.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
(b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2
(d) Neither 1 nor 2

100. Which of the following are the special provisions for the Union Territory of Delhi, as mentioned in the constitution?

1. The Chief Minister of Delhi is appointed by the President of India.
2. The State Assembly cannot make laws on the three matters of the State List: Public order, Police and land.
3. The Lieutenant Governor is empowered to promulgate ordinances during recess of the assembly.

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

- (a) 1 and 2 (b) 2 and 3
(c) 1 and 3 (d) 1, 2 and 3

Test Code:
2202

(English Version)

ANSWER & EXPLANATION
GENERAL STUDIES

TEST – 02

B

ANSWERS

Q. No.	Answers	Q. No.	Answers	Q. No.	Answers	Q. No.	Answers
1	(b)	26	(a)	51	(a)	76	(d)
2	(b)	27	(c)	52	(d)	77	(d)
3	(b)	28	(d)	53	(d)	78	(a)
4	(a)	29	(d)	54	(c)	79	(c)
5	(a)	30	(d)	55	(c)	80	(b)
6	(c)	31	(c)	56	(b)	81	(c)
7	(c)	32	(b)	57	(c)	82	(c)
8	(c)	33	(b)	58	(a)	83	(a)
9	(b)	34	(d)	59	(a)	84	(b)
10	(d)	35	(a)	60	(c)	85	(c)
11	(b)	36	(b)	61	(d)	86	(b)
12	(b)	37	(d)	62	(c)	87	(d)
13	(b)	38	(c)	63	(b)	88	(a)
14	(b)	39	(d)	64	(d)	89	(d)
15	(a)	40	(b)	65	(d)	90	(b)
16	(c)	41	(b)	66	(d)	91	(b)
17	(c)	42	(a)	67	(c)	92	(c)
18	(a)	43	(a)	68	(b)	93	(c)
19	(b)	44	(a)	69	(b)	94	(c)
20	(a)	45	(d)	70	(b)	95	(d)
21	(b)	46	(a)	71	(c)	96	(c)
22	(b)	47	(c)	72	(b)	97	(a)
23	(c)	48	(c)	73	(d)	98	(c)
24	(c)	49	(d)	74	(d)	99	(a)
25	(c)	50	(d)	75	(c)	100	(d)

1. (b)

Explanation:

According to the provisions of Articles 243ZD of the constitution of India, there shall be constituted in every district a **District Planning committee to consolidate the plans Prepared by the Panchayats and the Municipalities in the district** and to prepare a draft development plan for the district as a whole. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**

- The provision of District Planning Committee was added by the 74th Constitutional Amendment Act, 1992.

Composition of the District Planning committee

- The District Planning Committee of different districts shall consist of such number of members as may be specified by the state government by notification. **Hence, statement 2 is NOT correct.**
- The act lays down that **four-fifths of the members of a district planning committee** should be elected by the elected members of the district panchayat and municipalities in the district from amongst themselves. The representation of these members in the committee should be in proportion to the ratio between the rural and urban populations in the district. **Hence, statement 3 is correct.**

2. (b)

Explanation:

The Lokpal is the first institution of its kind in independent India, established under the Lokpal and Lokayuktas Act, 2013 to inquire and investigate allegations of corruption against public functionaries who fall within the scope and ambit of the above Act.

- The Lokpal has jurisdiction to inquire into allegations of corruption against anyone **who is or has been Prime Minister, or a Minister in the Union government, or a Member of Parliament, as well as officials of the Union Government under Groups A, B, C and D.**
- Also covered are chairpersons, members, officers and directors of any board, corporation, society, trust or autonomous body either established by an Act of Parliament or wholly or partly funded by the Union or State government. It also covers any society or trust or body that receives foreign contribution above ₹10 lakh

- **Institutions which are financed fully or partly by the government are under the jurisdiction of Lokpal,** but institutions aided by the Government are excluded. **Hence, statement 1 is NOT correct.**
- Lokpal will have power of superintendence and direction over any central investigation agency including CBI for cases referred to them by the Lokpal. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**

3. (b)

Explanation:

Qualifications for Election as President :

- A person to be eligible for election as President should fulfil the following qualifications:
 - He should be a citizen of India.
 - He should have completed 35 years of age.
 - He should be qualified for election as a member of the Lok Sabha.
 - He should not hold any office of profit under the Union government or any state government or any local authority or any other public authority.
- ◆ A sitting President or Vice-President of the Union, the Governor of any State, and a Minister of the Union or any State is not deemed to hold any office of profit and hence qualified as a presidential candidate.
- Further, the nomination of a candidate for election to the office of President must be subscribed by at least 50 electors as proposers and 50 electors as seconders. **Hence, statement 1 is NOT correct.**
- Every candidate has to make a security deposit of ₹15,000 in the Reserve Bank of India. The security deposit is liable to be forfeited in case the candidate fails to secure one-sixth of the votes polled. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**

4. (a)

Explanation:

- The Governor is the chief executive head of the State. But, like the President, he is a nominal executive head (titular or constitutional head). **Hence, option (a) is correct.**
- The Governor also acts as an agent of the central government. Therefore, the office of the Governor has a dual role.



5. (a)

Explanation:

The Central Administrative Tribunal had been established under Article 323 - A of the Constitution for adjudication of disputes and complaints with respect to recruitment and conditions of service of persons appointed to public services and posts in connection with the affairs of the Union or other authorities under the control of the Government.

- The CAT exercises original jurisdiction in relation to recruitment and all service matters of public servants covered by it. Its jurisdiction extends to the all-India services, the Central civil services, civil posts under the Centre and civilian employees of defence services. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- However, the members of the defence forces, officers and servants of the Supreme Court and the secretarial staff of the Parliament are not covered by it.
- The Tribunal is guided by the principles of natural justice in deciding cases and is not bound by the procedure, prescribed by the Civil Procedure Code. The Central Administrative Tribunal is empowered to frame its own rules of procedure and practice. **Hence, statement 2 is NOT correct.**

6. (c)

Explanation:

Food Fortification:

- Food Fortification is a scientifically proven, cost-effective, scalable and sustainable global intervention that addresses the issue of micronutrient deficiencies.
- FSSAI operationalized the **Food Safety and Standards (Fortification of Foods) Regulations, 2016** for fortifying staples namely **Wheat Flour and Rice** (with Iron, Vitamin B12 and Folic Acid), **Milk and Edible Oil** (with Vitamins A and D) and **Double Fortified Salt** (with Iodine and Iron) to reduce the high burden of micronutrient malnutrition in India.
- The '+F' logo has been notified to identify fortified foods. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**

Benefits of Fortification:

- Fortification is a safe method of improving nutrition among people.
- The quantity added is **so small** and so well regulated as per prescribed standards that likelihood of an overdose of nutrients is unlikely.

- It does not require any changes in food habits and patterns of people. It is a socio-culturally acceptable way to deliver nutrients to people.
- It does not alter the characteristics of the food—the taste, the feel, the look.
- It can be implemented quickly as well as show results in **improvement** of health in a relatively **short period of time**.
- This method is **cost-effective** especially if the advantage is taken of the existing technology and delivery platforms.
- It requires an initial investment to purchase both the equipment and the vitamin and mineral premix, but overall costs of fortification are extremely low. Even when all program costs are passed on to consumers, the price increase is approximately 1-2%, less than normal price variation. Thus, it has a **high benefit-to-cost ratio**.
- It is a valid technology for reducing micronutrient malnutrition as part of a **food-based approach** when and where existing food supplies and limited access fail to provide adequate levels of the respective nutrients in the diet. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**

7. (c)

Explanation:

Public Accounts Committee:

- This committee was set up first in 1921 under the provisions of the Government of India Act of 1919 and has since been in existence.
 - Montagu-Chelmsford reforms formed the basis of the Government of India Act of 1919. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- At present, it consists of 22 members (15 from the Lok Sabha and 7 from the Rajya Sabha).
- The members are elected by the Parliament every year from amongst its members according to the principle of proportional representation by means of the single transferable vote.
- The function of the committee is to examine the annual audit reports of the Comptroller and Auditor General of India (CAG), which are laid before the Parliament by the President.
- In 2017, PAC summoned the then RBI governor Urjit Patel for scrutiny of the major policy decision. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**



8. (c)

Explanation:

Grants-in-Aid to the States:

Besides sharing taxes between the Centre and the States, the Constitution provides for grants-in-aid to the states from the Central resources. There are two types of grants-in-aid, viz, statutory grants and discretionary grants:

Statutory Grants:

- **Article 275** empowers the Parliament to make grants to the states which are in need of financial assistance and not to every state.
- These sums are charged on the Consolidated Fund of India every year.
- The statutory grants under Article 275 are given to the states on the recommendation of the Finance Commission. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**

Discretionary Grants:

- **Article 282** empowers both the Centre and the States to make any grants for any public purpose, even if it is not within their respective legislative competence. Under this provision, the Centre makes grants to the states.
- These grants are also known as discretionary grants, the reason being that the Centre is under no obligation to give these grants and the matter lies within its discretion.

Surcharge on Certain Taxes and Duties for Purposes of the Centre (Article 271):

- The Parliament can at any time levy the surcharges on taxes and duties referred to in Article 269 and 270 of the Constitution. The proceeds of such surcharges go to the Centre exclusively. In other words, the states have no share in these surcharges.
- However, the Goods and Services Tax (GST) is exempted from this surcharge. In other words, this surcharge can not be imposed on the GST. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**

9. (b)

Explanation:

Administration of Tribal Areas:

The Constitution, under Sixth Schedule, contains special provisions for the administration of tribal areas in the

four northeastern states of **Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura and Mizoram. Hence, statement 1 is NOT correct.**

The various features of administration contained in the Sixth Schedule are as follows:

1. The tribal areas in the four states have been constituted as Autonomous Districts. But, they do not fall outside the executive authority of the state concerned.
2. The Governor is empowered to organise and re-organise the Autonomous Districts.
3. If there are different tribes in an Autonomous District, the Governor can divide the district into several autonomous regions.
4. Each Autonomous District has a District Council consisting of 30 members, of whom four are nominated by the Governor and the remaining 26 are elected. Each autonomous Region also has a separate Regional Council.
5. The District and Regional Councils administer the areas under their jurisdiction. They can make laws on certain specified matters like land, forests, canal water, shifting cultivation, village administration, the inheritance of property, marriage and divorce, social customs and so on. But all such laws require the assent of the governor.
6. The District and Regional Councils within their territorial jurisdictions can constitute village councils or courts for trial of suits and cases between the tribes.
7. The District Council can establish, construct or manage primary schools, dispensaries, markets, ferries, fisheries, roads and so on in the district.
8. The District and Regional Councils are empowered to assess and collect land revenue and to impose certain specified taxes.
9. **The acts of Parliament or the state legislature do not apply to autonomous districts and autonomous regions or apply with specified modifications and exceptions. Hence, statement 2 is correct.**
10. The Governor can appoint a commission to examine and report on any matter relating to the administration of the autonomous districts or regions.



10. (d)

Explanation:

According to **rule 198 of the Rules of Procedure and Conduct of the Lok Sabha**, a no-confidence motion is “a motion expressing want of confidence in the Council of Ministers.” It is not mentioned in the Constitution. **Hence, statement 1 is NOT correct.**

- A no-confidence motion **needs a majority vote to pass the House**. If individuals or parties abstain from voting, those numbers will be removed from the overall strength of the House and then the majority will be taken into account.
- In 1952, the lower limit of a no-confidence was at 30 MPs. **J.B. Kripalani, or Acharya Kripalani** as he was known, moved the first-ever no-confidence motion in **August 1963 against the J.L. Nehru government** after the India-China war. **Hence, statement 2 is NOT correct.**
- No-confidence motions in the Lal Bahadur Shastri and Indira Gandhi years were also unsuccessful — three against Shastri and 12 against Gandhi.
- The first motion that almost passed, and led to the falling of a government was that by Y.B. Chavan against the Morarji Desai government. Only almost, because Desai resigned before the motion could be put to vote.
- The Atal Bihari Vajpayee government, in 1999 lost power, when they lost a no-confidence motion, after their ally AIADMK pulled out of the coalition. The ruling NDA got 269 votes, while the Opposition got 270 votes, beating out the government.

11. (b)

Explanation:

The salient features of the Family Courts Act, 1984 are as follows:

1. It provides for the establishment of Family Courts by the State Governments in consultation with the High Courts.
2. It makes it obligatory on the State Governments to set up a Family Court in every city or town with a population exceeding one million. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
3. It enables the State Governments to set up Family Courts in other areas also, if they deem it necessary.

4. It exclusively provides within the jurisdiction of the Family Courts the matters relating to:-
(i) matrimonial relief, including nullity of marriage, judicial separation, divorce, restitution of conjugal rights, or declaration as to the validity of marriage or as to the matrimonial status of any person; (ii) the property of the spouses or of either of them; (iii) declaration as to the legitimacy of any person; (iv) guardianship of a person or the custody of any minor; and (v) maintenance of wife, children and parents.
5. It makes it obligatory on the part of the Family Court to endeavour, in the first instance, to effect a reconciliation or a settlement between the parties to a family dispute. During this stage, the proceedings will be informal and rigid rules of procedure shall not apply.
6. It provides for the association of social welfare agencies, counsellors, etc., during the conciliation stage and also to secure the service of medical and welfare experts.
7. It provides that the parties to a dispute before a Family Court shall not be entitled, as of right, to be represented by a legal practitioner. However, the Court may, in the interest of justice, seek assistance of a legal expert as amicus curiae. **Hence, statement 2 is NOT correct.**
8. It simplifies the rules of evidence and procedure so as to enable a Family Court to deal effectively with a dispute.
9. It provides for only one right of appeal which shall lie to the High Court. **Hence, statement 3 is correct.**

12. (b)

Explanation:

Cyclical policy of the fiscal policy:

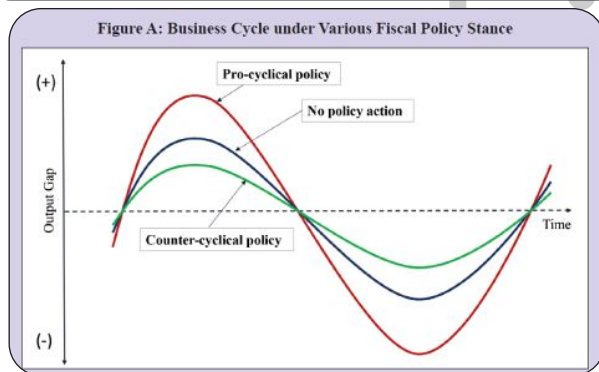
- Cyclical policy of the fiscal policy refers to a change in direction of government expenditure and taxes based on economic conditions.
- These pertain to decisions by policymakers based on the fluctuations in economic growth. There are two types of cyclical fiscal policies - **counter-cyclical and procyclical.**



Counter-cyclical Fiscal Policy

- Counter-cyclical fiscal policy refers to the steps taken by the government that go against the direction of the economic or business cycle.
- Thus, in a recession or slowdown, the government increases expenditure and reduces taxes to create a demand that can drive an economic boom.
- In Recession**
 - The government takes the route of **Expansionary Fiscal Policy** i.e. the **government expenditure is increased and taxes are reduced. Hence, statement 1 is NOT correct.**
 - This increases the consumption potential of the economy and helps soften the recession.
- In Economic Boom**
 - The government takes the route of **contractionary Fiscal Policy** i.e. the government expenditure is decreased and taxes are increased. This decreases the consumption potential of the economy and helps moderate the boom. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**

Fiscal policy (FP) stance	Recession (↓ GDP)	Expansion (↑ GDP)	Outcome
Pro-cyclical	<u>Contractionary FP</u> ↓ Govt. Expenditure or /and ↑ Taxes	<u>Expansionary FP</u> ↑ Govt. Expenditure or /and ↓ Taxes	Deepens recessions and amplifies expansions, thereby increasing fluctuations in the business cycle.
Counter-cyclical	<u>Expansionary FP</u> ↑ Govt. Expenditure or /and ↓ Taxes	<u>Contractionary FP</u> ↓ Govt. Expenditure or /and ↑ Taxes	Softens the recession and moderates the expansions, thereby decreasing fluctuations in the business cycle.



13. (b)

Explanation:

Swachh Bharat Mission-Rural and Urban

Objectives

- The objective of **SBM-Rural** was to attain **Open Defecation Free (ODF) India** by 2nd October 2019 by

providing access to toilet facilities to all rural households in the country.

- The objective of **SBM-Urban** is to achieve **100 percent Open Defecation Free (ODF)** status and **100 percent scientific processing of the Municipal Solid Waste (MSW)** being generated in the country.

Targets and achievements

- Under SBM, rural sanitation coverage has made a huge leap in the target achievement with more than **10 crore toilets built** across rural India.
- With a view to **sustain the gains made under the programme** in the last five years and to ensure that no one is left behind and to achieve the overall cleanliness in villages, **phase II of SBM(G)** from 2020-21 to 2024-25 is being implemented focusing on **ODF sustainability and Solid & Liquid Waste Management (SLWM)** through convergence between different verticals of financing and various Schemes of Central and State Governments such as 15th Finance Commission grants to local bodies, MNREGS, Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR) funds etc. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**
- Since its launch in 2014, SBM-U has made significant progress in the area of both sanitation and solid waste management. **4,327 Urban Local Bodies (ULBs) have been declared ODF so far.**
- This has been made possible through the construction of more than **66 lakhs of individual household toilets** and over **6 lakhs community/public toilets**, far exceeding the Mission's targets.
- The Mission is now focusing on holistic sanitation through its **ODF+ and ODF++ protocols** with a total of 1,319 cities certified ODF+ and 489 cities certified ODF++ as on date.
- In the area of solid waste management, **100 percent of wards have complete door-to door collection.** Further, out of **1,40,588 Tonnes Per Day (TPD)** waste generated\ per day, **68 percent (i.e., 95,676 TPD)** is being processed. **Hence, statement 1 is NOT correct.**

ODF, ODF+ and ODF++ Protocol:

- Norms under ODF:** No visible faeces shall be found in the environment and every household, as well as public/community institutions, should be using safe technology options for disposal of faeces.



- **Norms under ODF+:** Not a single person should be defecating and/or urinating in the open. All community and public toilets should be properly maintained and cleaned.
- **Norms under ODF++:** Proper treatment and management of faecal sludge/septage and sewage is safely managed and treated. There should be no discharge or dumping of untreated faecal sludge/septage and sewage in drains, water bodies or open areas.

14. (b)

Explanation:

- Currently, in case of a bank collapse, a depositor can claim an amount up to a maximum of ₹ 5 lakh as the insurance cover. This amount is termed 'deposit insurance'- the insurance cover against the deposits of an individual in banks. **Hence, statement 1 is NOT correct.**
- The insurance cover is provided by the Deposit Insurance and Credit Guarantee Corporation (DICGC).

Deposit Insurance and Credit Guarantee Corporation

- DICGC came into existence in 1978 after the merger of Deposit Insurance Corporation (DIC) and Credit Guarantee Corporation of India Ltd. (CGCI) after passing of the Deposit Insurance and Credit Guarantee Corporation Act, 1961 by the Parliament. It serves as a deposit insurance and credit guarantee for banks in India. **It is a fully owned subsidiary of and is governed by the RBI. Hence, statement 2 is correct.**
- DICGC charges 10 paise per ₹ 100 of deposits held by a bank. The premium paid by the insured banks to the Corporation is paid by the banks and is not to be passed on to depositors.
- Banks, including regional rural banks, local area banks, foreign banks with branches in India, and cooperative banks, are mandated to take deposit insurance cover with the DICGC.

15. (a)

Explanation:

Interest Equalization Scheme (IES):

- The scheme came into effect from 01.04.2015 for a period of 5 years.

- This scheme is being implemented by the **Directorate General of Foreign Trade (DGFT)** through **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** for pre and post Shipment Rupee Export Credit. **Hence, statement 2 is NOT correct.**
- Under the Scheme, interest equalization @ 3 per cent per annum has been made available to **eligible exporters**. This would promote exports. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- The interest equalization rate has been increased from 3 per cent to 5 per cent for exports made by MSME sector under the ongoing Interest Equalization Scheme (IES) on Pre and post Shipment Rupee Export Credit. The merchant exporters have also been included at the interest equalization rate of 3 per cent under this scheme.

16. (c)

Explanation:

- Cryogenics is the study of the production and behaviour of materials at extremely low temperatures (below -150 degree Centigrade).
- Cryogenic rocket engines, **run on liquid hydrogen and liquid oxygen, and are more efficient than solid propellants** or even other liquid engines. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- Liquid fuels are less bulky than solid ones; flow better than gaseous fuels and many of them have sufficient energy density to be considered desirable. Liquid hydrogen, is required to be kept at minus 253 degrees Centigrade if it is not to evaporate.
- Liquid oxygen requires temperatures of minus 183 degrees Centigrade. Liquid oxygen is a common cryogenic liquid oxidizer propellant.
- Due to liquid hydrogen and oxygen, the engine provides **more thrust for every kilogram of propellant it burns compared to solid and gaseous propellants** in rocket. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**

India has become the 6th country to successfully test an indigenous cryogenic engine. ISRO has developed the indigenous cryogenic C25 stage engine for GSLV MK III.

- It operates on Gas Generator Cycle using extremely low temperature propellants **Liquid Hydrogen (LH2) at 20 Kelvin (-253°C) and Liquid Oxygen (LOX) at 80K (193°C).** **Hence, statement 3 is correct.**



17. (c)

Explanation:

- The Vice-President occupies the second-highest office in the country. He is accorded a rank next to the President in the official warrant of precedence. **Hence, statement 2 is NOT correct.**
- This office of Vice-President in India is modelled on the lines of the American Vice-President. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- The Vice-President is elected by the members of an electoral college consisting of the members (both elected and nominated) of both Houses of Parliament. **Hence, statement 3 is NOT correct.**
- The Vice-President's election, like that of the President's election, is held in accordance with the system of proportional representation by means of the single transferable vote and the voting is by secret ballot.
- The normal functions of the Vice-President are to preside over the council of states. It is only on a rare occasion, and that too for a temporary period, that he may be called upon to assume the duties of the President.
- All doubts and disputes in connection with the election of the Vice-President are inquired into and decided by the Supreme Court whose decision is final.
 - The election of a person as Vice-President cannot be challenged on the ground that the electoral college was incomplete (i.e., the existence of any vacancy among the members of the electoral college). **Hence, statement 4 is correct.**
 - If the election of a person as Vice-President is declared void by the Supreme Court, acts done by him before the date of such declaration of the Supreme Court are not invalidated (i.e., they continue to remain in force).

18. (a)

Explanation:

- The term of the Chief Minister is not fixed and he holds office during the pleasure of the Governor. However, this does not mean that the Governor can dismiss him at any time. He cannot be dismissed by the Governor as long as he enjoys the majority support in the Legislative Assembly. But, if he loses the confidence of the assembly, he must resign or the Governor can dismiss him. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**

- The salary and allowances of the Chief Minister are determined by the state legislature. In addition to the salary and allowances, which are payable to a member of the state legislature, he gets a sumptuary allowance, free accommodation, travelling allowance, medical facilities, etc. **Hence, statement 2 is NOT correct.**

19. (b)

Explanation:

Right to Information Act, 2005 (RTI Act) is an Act passed by the Parliament of India to provide for setting out the practical regime of the **right to information for citizens and replaces the erstwhile Freedom of Information Act, 2002.**

- Under the provisions of the Act, any citizen of India can **request information from a “public authority” (a body of Government or “instrumentality of State”)** which is required to reply expeditiously or maximum within thirty days.
- Under section 2(h) of the RTI Act “Public authority” means any authority or body or institution of self government established or constituted—
 - by or under the Constitution;
 - by any other law made by Parliament/State Legislature.
 - by notification issued or order made by the appropriate Government, and includes any—
 - ◆ body owned, controlled or substantially financed;
 - ◆ non-Government organisation substantially financed, directly or indirectly by funds provided by the appropriate Government. **Hence, statement 1 is NOT correct.**
- The Act also **requires every public authority** to computerize its records for wide dissemination and to proactively disclose certain categories of information so that the citizens need minimum recourse to request for information. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**
- The basic object of the Right to Information Act is to empower the citizens, promote transparency and accountability in the working of the Government

20. (a)

Explanation:

- The Law Commission of India is neither a constitutional body nor a statutory body, it is an executive body established by an order of the Government of India. Its



major function is to work for legal reforms. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**

- The Commission is established for a fixed tenure of **three years** and works as an **advisory body** to the **Ministry of Law and Justice**. **Hence, statement 3 is NOT correct.**
- Apart from having a full-time chairperson, the commission will have **four full-time members**, including a member-secretary. Law and Legislative Secretaries in the Law Ministry will be the ex-officio members of the commission. It will also have not **more than five part-time members**. **A retired Supreme Court judge or Chief Justice of a High Court heads the Commission**. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**

Roles and functions:

1. The Law Commission shall, on a reference made to it by the Central Government or suo moto, **undertake research in law and review of existing laws in India for making reforms and enacting new legislation.**
2. It shall also undertake studies and research for **bringing reforms in the justice delivery systems** for elimination of delay in procedures, speedy disposal of cases, reduction in cost of litigation, etc.

21. (b)

Explanation:

The Parliament has laid down the following additional disqualifications in the **Representation of the People Act (1951)**:

- He must not have been found guilty of certain election offences or corrupt practices in the elections.
- He must not have been convicted for any offence resulting in imprisonment for two or more years. But, the detention of a person under a **preventive detention** law is **not** a disqualification. **Hence, statement 1 is NOT correct.**
- He must not have failed to lodge an account of his election expenses within the stipulated timeframe.
- **Disqualification on ground of defection** The Constitution also lays down that a person shall be disqualified from being a member of Parliament if he is so disqualified on the ground of defection under the

provisions of the **Tenth Schedule**. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**

- Grounds of disqualification under anti-defection law:
 - if he voluntarily gives up the membership of the political party on whose ticket he is elected to the House;
 - if he votes or abstains from voting in the House contrary to any direction given by his political party;
 - if any independently elected member joins any political party; and
 - if any nominated member joins any political party after the expiry of six months.
 - The question of disqualification under the Tenth Schedule is decided by the **Chairman** in the case of **Rajya Sabha** and **Speaker** in the case of **Lok Sabha** (and not by the President of India). In 1992, the Supreme Court ruled that the decision of the Chairman/Speaker in this regard is subject to judicial review. **Hence, statement 3 is NOT correct.**

22. (b)

Explanation:

- The earliest literature 'Rig-Veda' reveals that some kind of population count was maintained during 800-600 BC in India. **Hence, statement 1 is NOT correct.**
- The celebrated 'Arthashastra' by 'Kautilya' written in the 3rd Century BC prescribed the collection of population statistics as a measure of state policy for taxation. It contained a detailed description of methods of conducting population, economic and agricultural censuses.
- During the regime of the Mughal king Akbar, the administrative report 'Ain-e-Akbari' included comprehensive data pertaining to population, industry, wealth and many other characteristics.
- A systematic and modern population census, in its present form was conducted non synchronously between 1865 and 1872 in different parts of the country. This effort culminating in 1872 has been popularly labeled as the first population census of India.
- However, the first synchronous census in India was held in 1881. Since then, censuses have been undertaken uninterrupted once every ten year. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**



23. (c)

Explanation:

- The **Chief Election Commissioner (CEC)** of India, along with Election Commissioners, are **appointed by the President** of India. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- The CEC has a fixed tenure of six years, or up to the age of 65 years, whichever is earlier.
- They can resign anytime or can also be removed before the expiry of their term. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**
 - The CEC can be removed from office only through a process of removal similar to that of a SC judge by Parliament.
- Judges of High Courts and Supreme Court, CEC, Comptroller and Auditor General (CAG) may be removed from office through a motion adopted by Parliament on grounds of 'proved misbehaviour or incapacity'.
- Removal requires a special majority of 2/3rd members present and voting supported by more than 50% of the total strength of the house.

24. (c)

Explanation:

Neoclassical Growth Theory:

- The Neoclassical Growth Theory is an economic model of growth that outlines how a steady economic growth rate results when three economic forces come into play: labor, capital, and technology.
- The simplest and most popular version of the Neoclassical Growth Model is the Solow-Swan Growth Model.
- Robert Solow and Trevor Swan first introduced the **Solow-Swan growth model in 1956. Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- The theory states that economic growth is the result of three factors—**labor, capital, and technology. Hence, statement 2 is correct.**
- The Solow Model highlights that output per worker mainly depends on savings, population growth and technological progress.
- While an economy has limited resources in terms of capital and labor, the contribution from technology to growth is boundless.

25. (c)

Explanation:

- **The World Economic Forum (WEF)** has announced the launch of an Essential Digital Infrastructure and Services Network (EDISON) Alliance.
- **Aim:** To work towards ensuring global and equitable access to the digital economy. **Hence, option (c) is correct.**
- The alliance will work with governments and industries. It will accelerate digital inclusion and will ensure cross-sectoral collaboration between the technology industry and other critical sectors of the economy.
- The World Economic Forum (WEF) will serve as the secretariat and platform for the Alliance.

26. (a)

Explanation:

Extinction Rebellion

- It was launched in the United Kingdom in 2018 as a response to a report by the Intergovernmental Panel on Climate Change (IPCC).
- **Purpose:** The movement describes itself as a decentralized, international, and politically non-partisan movement.
- It is a global movement which seeks to “rebel”, and asks groups to “self-organise”, without the need for anyone’s permission, to come up with collective action plans as long as they adhere to the group’s core principles and values. **Hence, statement 2 is NOT correct.**
- It uses non-violent direct action and civil disobedience to persuade governments to act on the Climate and Ecological Emergency. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- **Logo:** The logo of the movement is an ‘X’ with the top and bottom cross. It resembles an hourglass which stands for a warning that time is running out for many species. The extinction (X) hourglass is placed within a circle that represents the planet Earth.
- **Core Demands:** The group has three core demands: The Government should “Tell the Truth”, “Act Now” and “Go Beyond Politics”. By that, it confronts the climate and ecological emergency that the world is facing.



27. (c)

Explanation:

NIRVIK (Niryat Rin Vikas Yojana):

Export Credit Guarantee Corporation of India (ECGC) has introduced the Export Credit Insurance Scheme (ECIS) called NIRVIK to enhance loan availability and ease the lending process. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**

- It is an insurance cover guarantee that will cover up to 90% of the principal and interest. The cover will include both pre and post-shipment credit. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
 - The ECGC currently provides credit guarantee of up to 60% loss.
- The enhanced cover will ensure that Foreign and Rupee export credit interest rates will be below 4% and 8% respectively for exporters.

28. (d)

Explanation:

- The following powers are enjoyed by the Chief Minister as head of the State Council of Ministers:
 - I. The Governor appoints only those persons as ministers who are recommended by the Chief Minister.
 - II. The Chief Minister allocates and reshuffles the portfolios among ministers. **Hence, statement 1 is NOT correct.**
 - III. He can ask a minister to resign or advise the Governor to dismiss him in case of a difference of opinion. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**
 - IV. He presides over the meetings of the Council of Ministers and influences its decisions.
 - V. He guides, directs, controls, and coordinates the activities of all the ministers.
 - VI. He can bring about the collapse of the Council of Ministers by resigning from office. **Hence, statement 3 is correct.**
- Since the Chief Minister is the head of the Council of Ministers, his resignation or death automatically dissolves the Council of Ministers.
- The resignation or death of any other minister, on the other hand, merely creates a vacancy, which the Chief Minister may or may not like to fill.

29. (d)

Explanation:

Like the Supreme Court, the high court has been vested with quite extensive and effective powers. It is the highest court of appeal in the state. It is the protector of the Fundamental Rights of the citizens. It is vested with the power to interpret the Constitution. Besides, it has supervisory and consultative roles.

Original Jurisdiction:

It means the power of a high court to hear disputes in the first instance, not by way of appeal. It extends to the following:

- (a) **Matters of admiralty, will, marriage, divorce, company laws and contempt of court. Hence, statement 3 is correct.**
- (b) **Disputes relating to the election of members of Parliament and state legislatures. Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- (c) Regarding revenue matter or an act ordered or done in revenue collection.
- (d) **Enforcement of fundamental rights of citizens. Hence, statement 2 is correct.**
- (e) Cases ordered to be transferred from a subordinate court involving the interpretation of the Constitution to its own file.
- (f) The four high courts (i.e., Calcutta, Bombay, Madras and Delhi High Courts) have original civil jurisdiction in cases of higher value. Before 1973, the Calcutta, Bombay and Madras High Courts also had original criminal jurisdiction. This was fully abolished by the Criminal Procedure Code, 1973.

30. (d)

Explanation:

The Election Commission of India recently declared the National People's Party (NPP) as a national party, making it the **first from the north eastern** region to earn this status. **Hence, statement 1 is NOT correct.**

- The NPP is recognised as a State party in Arunachal Pradesh, Manipur, Meghalaya and Nagaland.
- It became the 8th national political party in the country. A party is recognized as national party by the Election Commission if it fulfils at least one of the following qualifications:



- If it secures **six per cent of valid votes polled in any four or more states at a general election to the Lok Sabha** or to the **legislative assembly**; and, in addition, it wins four seats in the Lok Sabha from any state or states; or
- If it wins **two per cent of seats in the Lok Sabha** at a general election; and **these candidates are elected from three states**; or
- If it is recognized as a **state party in four states**
- The Election Commission, however, has no power to de-register political parties. **Hence, statement 2 is NOT correct.**

31. (c)

Explanation:

Schedules of Indian Constitution:

- Provisions related to the forms of oaths and affirmation are provided in the third schedule. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- Fifth schedule of Indian constitution is concerned with the provisions relating to the administration and control of scheduled areas and scheduled tribes.
- Sixth schedule of Indian constitution explains the provisions relating to the administration of tribal areas in the states of Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura and Mizoram. **Hence, statement 2 is NOT correct.**
- **Eighth schedule** provides information related to the languages recognized by the Constitution of India. From time to time, language have been added in the list in eighth schedule. Sindhi was added by the 21st Amendment Act of 1967. **Hence, statement 3 is correct.**
- Currently, there are 22 languages in the eighth schedule.

32. (b)

Explanation:

- The doctrine of judicial review originated and developed in the USA.
- The Supreme Court has declared the power of judicial review as a basic feature of the Constitution or an element of the basic structure of the Constitution. Hence, the power of judicial review cannot be curtailed or excluded even by a constitutional amendment. **Hence, statement 1 is NOT correct.**
- The phrase '**Judicial Review**' has nowhere been used in the Constitution. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**

- The constitutional validity of a legislative enactment or an executive order can be challenged in the Supreme Court or in the High Courts on the following three grounds:
 - (a) it infringes the Fundamental Rights (Part III),
 - (b) it is outside the competence of the authority which has framed it, and
 - (c) it is repugnant to the constitutional provisions.

33. (b)

Explanation:

National Means Cum-Merit Scholarship Scheme (NMMSS)

It is a scheme by the Ministry of Education. **Hence, statement 1 is NOT correct.**

Key Points About NMMSS:

- **Aim:**
 - The objective of the National Means Cum-Merit Scholarship Scheme (NMMSS) is to award scholarships to meritorious students of **economically weaker sections** to reduce drop-outs in class VIII.
 - It also intends to encourage students to continue the study at a secondary stage.
- **Type:**
 - It is the **Centrally Sponsored Scheme (CSS)** which was launched in 2008.
- **Details about Scholarship:**
 - **Scholarship of Rs. 6000/- per annum (Rs.500/- per month)** per student is awarded to selected students every year for study in classes from IX to XII in State Government, Government aided and local body schools.
 - The selection of students award of the scholarships is made through an examination conducted by the State Governments.
 - Scholarships are disbursed by the **State Bank of India directly into the bank accounts** of students on a quarterly basis
- **Eligibility Criteria:**
 - Students whose parental income from all sources is not more than Rs. 1,50,000/- per annum are eligible to avail the scholarships.
 - The students studying in Kendriya Vidyalaya, Jawahar Navodaya Vidyalayas, Residential Schools run by the State Government Institutions and private schools are not eligible for the scholarship under this scheme. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**



34. (d)

Explanation:

Trends In Social Sector Expenditure:

- The expenditure on social services (education, health and others) by Centre and States as a proportion of Gross Domestic Product (GDP) **increased by 1.5 percentage points** from 6.2 to 7.7 per cent, during the period 2014-15 to 2019-20. **Hence, statement 1 is NOT correct.**
- An increase was witnessed across all social sectors during this period.
- **For education**, it increased from **2.8 per cent in 2014-15 to 3.1 per cent** in 2019-20 and **for health** from **1.2 to 1.6 per cent**. **Hence, statement 2 is NOT correct.**

35. (a)

Explanation:

- India consistently runs a trade surplus with the USA and United Arab Emirates, 2014-15.
- On the other hand, India continuously has trade deficit since 2014-15 with respect to other major trading partners i.e. China, Saudi Arabia, Iraq, Germany, Korea RP, Indonesia and Switzerland.
- India had trade surplus with **Hong Kong and Singapore** till 2017-18, before it changed to trade deficit in 2018-19.

Trade Surplus Countries		Values in US\$ Billion
1.	U S A	10.91
2.	United Arab Emirates	0.25

Trade Deficit Countries		Values in US\$ Billion
1.	China PRP	-35.32
2.	Saudi Arabia	-14.32
3.	Iraq	-13.98
4.	Germany	-3.09
5.	Hong Kong	-3.88
6.	Singapore	-3.15

Hence, option (a) is correct.

36. (b)

Explanation:

- Some important roles performed by the Prime Minister are as follows:
 - I. He is the chairman of the NITI Ayog, National Integration Council, Inter-State Council, National Water Resources Council, and some other bodies.

- II. He plays a significant role in shaping the foreign policy of the country.
- III. He is the chief spokesman of the Union government.
- IV. He is the crisis manager-in-chief at the political level during emergencies.
- V. As a leader of the nation, he meets various sections of people in different states and receives memoranda from them regarding their problems, and so on.
- VI. He is the leader of the party in power.
- VII. He is the political head of the services.

- The President of India summons a joint sitting of both the Houses of Parliament to resolve the deadlock, which is presided over by the Speaker of the Lok Sabha. It is the legislative power of the President. **Hence, statement 3 is NOT correct.**

37. (d)

Explanation:

Recently, Manipur has launched an online portal for the travellers to seek Inner Line Permits.

- It is a travel document that allows an Indian citizen to visit or stay in a state that is protected under the ILP system.
- Foreigners need a **Protected Area Permit (PAP)** to visit tourist places which are different from Inner Line Permits needed by domestic tourists.
- The system is in force today in four North eastern states — Arunachal Pradesh, Nagaland, Manipur and Mizoram. **Hence, statement 1 is NOT correct.**
- No Indian citizen can visit any of these states unless he or she belongs to that state, nor can he or she overstay beyond the period specified in the ILP.
- The concept stems from the Bengal Eastern Frontier Regulation Act, 1873, where the British framed regulations restricting the entry and regulating the stay of outsiders in designated areas.
- An ILP is issued by the state government concerned. It can be obtained after applying either online or physically. **Hence, statement 2 is NOT correct.**
- It states the dates of travel and also specifies the particular areas in the state which the ILP holder can travel to.



38. (c)

Explanation:

- The government highlighted the work done under **Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act (MGNREGA), 2005**, by providing employment to rural people.
 - The government has allocated Rs. 61,500 crore for MGNREGA for the Financial Year 2020-21, which is an all-time high.
 - Additional provision of Rs. 40,000 crore has been made for this programme under Atmanirbhar Bharat Abhiyan to provide employment to the needy workers during the difficult period due to Covid-19.
- The government has also stressed on the irrigation and water conservation activities under the MGNREGA.
- **Central Employment Guarantee Council:**
 - The Central Council **has been constituted under Section 10 of the MGNREGA. Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
 - It is chaired by the Minister of Rural development. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**
 - It is responsible for advising the Central Government on MGNREGA related matters, and for monitoring and evaluating the implementation of the Act.
 - It prepares Annual Reports on the implementation of MGNREGA for submission to Parliament.

39. (d)

Explanation:

- There is an independent 'Committee of privileges' in each house of Parliament.
- In the Lok Sabha, the Speaker nominates a **Committee of privileges consisting of 15 members** as per respective party strengths.
- **In the Rajya Sabha, the deputy chairperson heads the committee of privileges**, that consists of 10 members.

Hence, both statements 1 and 2 are NOT correct.

40. (b)

Explanation:

- **Article 163** provides for a Council of Ministers with the Chief Minister at the head to aid and advise the Governor in the exercise of his functions except for the discretionary ones.

- If any question arises whether a matter falls within the Governor's discretion or not, the decision of the Governor is final and the validity of anything done by him cannot be called in question on the ground that he ought or ought not to have acted in his discretion. **Hence, option (b) is correct.**
- Further, the nature of advice tendered by Ministers to the Governor cannot be enquired by any court. This provision emphasizes the intimate and confidential relationship between the Governor and the Ministers.

41. (b)

Explanation:

Report of The Committee to Review Governance of Boards of Banks in India (PJ Nayak Committee):

Terms of Reference:

1. To review the regulatory compliance requirements of banks' boards in India, to judge what can be rationalised and where requirements need to be enhanced.
2. To examine the working of banks' boards including whether adequate time is devoted to issues of strategy, growth, governance and risk management.
3. To review central bank regulatory guidelines on bank ownership, ownership concentration and representation in the board.
4. To analyse the representation on bank boards to see whether the boards have the appropriate mix of capabilities and the necessary independence to govern the institution, and to investigate possible conflicts of interest in board representation, including among owner representatives and regulators. In this and review the 'fit and proper' criteria, for all categories of directors of banks, including tenure of directorship.
5. Any other issue relevant to the functioning of the banks' boards and the governance they exercise.

Recommendations:

1. Repeal the Bank Nationalisation Act (1970, 1980), the SBI Act and the SBI Subsidiaries Act. This is because these acts require the government to have above 50% share in the banks.
2. After the above acts are repealed, the government should set up a Bank Investment Company (BIC) as a holding company or a core investment company.



3. The government to transfer its share in the banks to this BIC. Thus, the BIC would become the parent holding company of all these national banks, which would become subsidiaries. As a result of this, all the PSBs (public sector banks) would become 'limited' banks. BIC will be autonomous and have the power to appoint the Board of Directors and make other policy decisions.
4. Until the BIC is formed, a **temporary body called the Bank Boards Bureau (BBB)** will be formed to do the functions of the BIC. Once BIC is formed, the BBB will be dissolved.
5. The BBB will advice on appointments to the board, banks' chairman and other executive directors.

Hence, option (b) is correct.

42. (a)

Explanation:

The Technology Information, Forecasting and Assessment Council (TIFAC) has launched two new initiatives - SAKSHAM (Shramik Shakti Manch) Job Portal and a Seaweed Mission.

- TIFAC is an autonomous organization set up in 1988 under the **Department of Science & Technology** to look ahead in the technology domain, assess the technology trajectories, and support innovation by networked actions in select areas of national importance.

Hence, option (a) is correct.

SAKSHAM Portal:

- **About:**
 - It is a dynamic portal for jobs/mapping the skills of Shramiks (workers) vis-a-vis requirements of Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises (MSMEs) and other industries all across the country. It is an all India Portal.
 - It will facilitate creation of 10 lakh blue collar jobs.

Seaweeds Mission:

- It has been **launched for commercial farming** of seaweeds and its processing for value addition towards boosting the national economy.
- **It envisages following activities:**
 - ◆ Establishing model demonstration farms over one hectare for cultivation of economically important seaweeds in nearshore and onshore along the Indian coast.

- ◆ Establishment of seaweed nurseries for supplying seed material for large scale farming of economically important seaweeds in the country.
- ◆ Establishment and demonstration of processing technologies/recipes for edible seaweeds in line with consumer acceptability or cultural food habits.
- ◆ An activity on seaweed cluster development including value chain development, supply chain development, collection of data on environmental, economic and social impacts of seaweed projects in the country.

43. (a)

Explanation:

Every High Court consists of a Chief Justice and such other Judges as the **President** may from time to time deem necessary to appoint. **Hence, option (a) is correct.** Thus, the Constitution does not specify the strength of a High Court and leaves it to the discretion of the President who determines it based on the workload.

44. (a)

Explanation:

Provisions as to Ministers as per Article 75 :

- The Prime Minister shall be appointed by the President and the other Ministers shall be appointed by the President on the advice of the Prime Minister.
- The total number of Ministers, including the Prime Minister, in the Council of Ministers, shall not exceed 15% of the total strength of the Lok Sabha. This provision was added by the 91st Amendment Act of 2003.
- A member of either house of Parliament belonging to any political party who is disqualified on the ground of defection shall also be disqualified to be appointed as a Minister. This provision was also added by the 91st Amendment Act of 2003.
- The Ministers shall hold office during the pleasure of the President. **Hence, option (a) is correct.**
- The Council of Ministers shall be collectively responsible to the Lok Sabha.
- The President shall administer the oaths of office and secrecy to a Minister.



- A Minister who is not a member of the Parliament (either house) for any period of six consecutive months shall cease to be a Minister.
- The salaries and allowances of Ministers shall be determined by the Parliament.

45. (d)

Explanation:

Municipal corporations are established in the states by the acts of the concerned state legislatures, and in the union territories by the acts of the Parliament of India.

- A municipal corporation has **three authorities**, namely, **the council, the standing committees and the commissioner.**
- **The Council is headed by a Mayor.** He is assisted by a Deputy Mayor. He is elected in a majority of the states for a one-year renewable term. He is basically an ornamental figure and a formal head of the corporation. His main function is to preside over the meetings of the Council. **Hence, statement 1 is NOT correct.**

The municipal commissioner is responsible for the implementation of the decisions taken by the council and its standing committees. Thus, he is the chief executive authority of the corporation. **Hence, statement 2 is NOT correct.**

46. (a)

Explanation:

- **Article 74** provides for a Council of Ministers with the Prime Minister at the head to aid and advise the President in the exercise of his functions.
- The **42nd and 44th Constitutional Amendment Acts** have made the advice **binding** on the President. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- Further, the nature of advice tendered by the Council of Ministers to the President cannot be inquired into by any court.
- **Appointment of Ministers:**
 - The Prime Minister is appointed by the President, while the other ministers are appointed by the President on the advice of the Prime Minister. This means that the President can appoint only those persons as ministers who are recommended by the Prime Minister.

- Usually, the members of Parliament, either Lok Sabha or Rajya Sabha, are appointed as ministers. A person who is not a member of either House of Parliament can also be appointed as a minister. But, within six months, he must become a member (either by election or by nomination) of either House of Parliament, otherwise, he ceases to be a minister.
- A minister who is a member of one House of Parliament has the right to speak and to take part in the proceedings of the other House, but he can only vote in the House of which he is a member. **Hence, statement 2 is NOT correct.**

47. (c)

Explanation:

The Constitution (Article 143) authorises the president to seek the opinion of the Supreme Court in the following matters:

- (a) On any question of law or fact of public importance which has arisen or which is likely to arise.
- (b) On any dispute arising out of any pre-constitution treaty, agreement, covenant, engagement, sanad or other similar instruments.

In the first case, the Supreme Court may tender or may refuse to tender its opinion to the President. But, in the second case, the Supreme Court 'must' tender its opinion to the President. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**

In both the cases, the opinion expressed by the Supreme Court is only advisory and not a judicial pronouncement. It is not binding on the president; he may follow or may not follow the opinion. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**

48. (c)

Explanation:

- The Vembanad-Kol Wetland System is the largest brackish, humid tropical wetland ecosystem in the Southwest coast of India. The wetland regularly supports 20,000 residential/migratory waterbirds, prawns, fishes and mangroves.
- Vembanad Kol wetland system fed by 10 rivers, covering an area of 1512 km², forms a typical and one of the largest estuarine systems of the western coastal wetland systems.



- The Vembanad supports the third largest population of waterfowl in India during the winter months
- Vembanad serves as a habitat for variety of finfish, shellfish, a nursery of several species of aquatic life, and a transitional ecotone between sea and land. Many fish species depend on the wetland for food, spawning and nursery.
- Alappuzha, Kochi and Thrissur towns which falls within Alappuzha, Ernakulam, and Thrissur districts of Kerala State respectively.
- This wetland system also serves as a sink and transformer for the agricultural and municipal wastes discharged into it.
- The whole area was originally occupied by mangrove swamps, with *Rhizophora apiculata*, *Derris heterophylla*, *Sonneratia alba*, *Acanthus ilicifolius*, *Acrostichum aureum*, and *Cerbera manghas*.
- Agriculture and fisheries in the wetland are considered to be conflicting values Rice cultivation is practiced in the polders covering a total area of 100 sq km in the Kuttanad belt - the rice bowl of Kerala – of the Vembanad and most of the area of the Kol; the yield of rice from the wetland is 4-6 times more than the uplands. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**
- Unabated growth of water hyacinths in Vembanad lake is posing to be a major hindrance to the livelihood of fishermen families living along the banks of the water body. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- The accumulation of the invasive water plants which are six-feet-deep in certain areas, is making it difficult to navigate the lake.

49. (d)

Explanation:

Responsibility of Ministers:

1. Collective Responsibility - As per Article 164, the Council of Ministers is collectively responsible to the Legislative Assembly of the State. This means that all the Ministers own joint responsibility to the Legislative Assembly for all their acts of omission and commission. They work as a team and swim or sink together. When the Legislative Assembly passes a no-confidence motion against the Council of Ministers, all the Ministers have to resign including those Ministers who are from the Legislative Council. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**

2. Individual Responsibility - Article 164 states that the Ministers hold office during the pleasure of the Governor. This means that the Governor can remove a Minister at a time when the Council of Ministers enjoys the confidence of the Legislative Assembly. But, the Governor can remove a Minister only on the advice of the Chief Minister.

Hence, statement 2 is correct.

3. No Legal Responsibility - As at the Centre, there is no provision in the Constitution for the system of legal responsibility of the Minister in the States. It is not required that an order of the Governor for a public act should be countersigned by a Minister. Moreover, the courts are barred from inquiring into the nature of advice tendered by the Ministers to the Governor. **Hence, statement 3 is correct.**

50. (d)

Explanation:

- The Article 76 of Indian Constitution provides for the office of the Attorney General of India, the highest law officer in the country.
- He is appointed by the president.

Requirements for appointment:

- Must be a citizen of India
- Must have been a judge of some high court for five years, or
- Must be an advocate of some high court for ten years, or
- Must be an eminent jurist, in the opinion of the president.
- The term of office of the AG is not fixed by the Constitution.
- He holds office during the pleasure of the president.
- He may also quit his office by submitting his resignation to the president.
- The Constitution does not contain the procedure and grounds for his removal.
- **Conventionally**, he resigns when the government (council of ministers) resigns or is replaced, as he is appointed on its advice. **Hence, statement 1 is NOT correct.**
- The remuneration of the AG is not fixed by the Constitution.



- He receives such remuneration as the president determines. **Hence, statement 2 is NOT correct.**
- He has the right of audience in all courts in the territory of India.
- He has the right to speak and to take part in the proceedings of both the Houses of Parliament or their joint sitting and any committee of the Parliament of which he may be named a member, but without a right to vote.
- He enjoys all the privileges and immunities that are available to a member of Parliament.

51. (a)

Explanation:

Source of Power of CJI to act as the master of Roster:

- **Article 145(1)** of the Constitution provides that subject to the provisions of any law made by Parliament, the Supreme Court may from time to time, with the approval of the President, make rules for regulating generally the practice and procedure of the court.
- **Article 246** read with Entry 77 of the Union List empowers the Parliament to make law in respect of the Constitution, organisation, jurisdiction and powers of the Supreme Court.
- **Article 77** provides that the executive power of the Union shall extend to the matters with respect to which Parliament has power to make laws.
- The Parliament has not made any law so far with regard to formation of benches or laying down the principles for distribution of judicial business or allocation of cases amongst the judges.
- But following the judgment of the **three-judge bench in Prakash Chand**, it has further been held that as far as the roster is concerned, which is an administrative function, the Chief Justice is the 'master of the roster' and he alone has the prerogative to constitute the benches of the court and allocate cases to the benches so constituted. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- Impeachment of Chief Justice of India can be initiated in either House of the Parliament. The motion must be signed by 100 members (in the case of Lok Sabha) or 50 members (in the case of Rajya Sabha) and given to the Speaker/Chairman. **Hence, statement 2 is NOT correct.**

52. (d)

Explanation:

The Governor of a State appoints the

- Advocate General of a state and determines his remuneration. The Advocate General holds office during the pleasure of the Governor.
- He appoints the state Election Commissioner and determines his conditions of service and tenure of office. However, the state Election Commissioner can be removed only in like manner and on the like grounds as a judge of a High Court.
- He appoints the Chairman and Members of the state public service commission. However, they can be removed only by the president and not by a governor. **Hence, option (d) is correct.**

53. (d)

Explanation:

- The following four are the more important Cabinet Committees:
 - Political Affairs Committee** - It deals with all policy matters pertaining to domestic and foreign affairs.
 - Economic Affairs Committee** - It directs and coordinates governmental activities in the economic sphere.
 - Appointments Committee** - It decides all higher level appointments in the Central Secretariat, Public Enterprises, Banks and Financial Institutions.
 - Parliamentary Affairs Committee** - It looks after the progress of government business in the Parliament.
- The first three committees are chaired by the Prime Minister and the last one by the Home Minister.
- Of all the Cabinet Committees, the most powerful is the Political Affairs Committee, often described as a "Super-Cabinet". **Hence, option (d) is correct.**
-

54. (c)

Explanation:

- The Kurubas of Karnataka are a traditional sheep rearing community. Presently, the Kurubas constitute 9.3% of the state's population and come under the backward classes category. **Hence, option (c) is correct.**



- A massive rally was organised by the Kuruba community to urge the state government of Karnataka to recommend the Centre to include the community in the Scheduled Tribe (ST) list.
- Kurubas in other states are known by different names – as Dhangars in Maharashtra, Rabaris or Raikas in Gujarat, Dewasis in Rajasthan and Gadarias in Haryana.

55. (c)

Explanation:

Darknet:

- **Internet consists of three layers:**
 - The **first layer is public**, consisting of sites that one uses frequently such as Facebook, Twitter, Amazon and LinkedIn. This layer makes up only 4% of the entire internet.
 - The **second layer, the deep web**, is a network where data is stored in inaccessible databases (i.e. cannot be accessed through traditional search engines like Google). It is used to provide access to a specific group of people.
 - ◆ The data is generally sensitive and private (government private data, bank data, cloud data etc), so kept out of reach.
 - ◆ The **third layer is the darknet** which is also known as a part of the 'Deep Web'. It is a network built over the internet which is encrypted.
 - ◆ It is basically a layer of the Internet accessible only by using special software like Tor (The Onion Router), or I2P, which stands for Invisible Internet Project. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**
 - ◆ Anything present on the dark web will not be pulled up in internet searches, thereby offering a high degree of anonymity.

The Onion Routing:

Onion routing is a technique for anonymous communication over a computer network. In an onion network, messages are encapsulated in layers of encryption, analogous to layers of an onion. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**

56. (b)

Explanation:

- The state legislature occupies a preeminent and central position in the political system of a State. Articles 168 to 212 in Part VI of the Constitution deal with the

organisation, composition, duration, officers, procedures, privileges, powers, and so on of the state legislature.

- Legislative Assembly, like the Lok Sabha, is not a continuing chamber. Its normal term is five years from the date of its first meeting after the general elections. The expiration of the period of five years operates as automatic dissolution of the assembly. However, the Governor is authorised to dissolve the assembly at any time (even before the completion of five years) to pave the way for fresh elections. **Hence, statement 1 is NOT correct.**
- The Legislative Council is a continuing chamber (like the Rajya Sabha), that is, it is a permanent body and is not subject to dissolution. But, one-third of its members retire on the expiration of every second year. So, a member continues as such for six years. The vacant seats are filled up by fresh elections and nominations (by Governor) at the beginning of every third year. The retiring members are also eligible for re-election and re-nomination any number of times. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**

57. (c)

Explanation:

- The **United Nations High Commissioner for Refugees (UNHCR)** has released its annual Global Trends report before **World Refugee Day (20th June)**. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- Global Trends is published every year to count and track the numbers of refugees, internally displaced people, people who have returned to their countries or areas of origin, asylum-seekers, stateless people and other populations of concern to UNHCR.

Key Points:

- **Nearly 80 million people were forcibly displaced** by the end of 2019 — which is nearly 1% of the global population. Half of those displaced were children.
- **Five countries account for two-thirds of people displaced across borders:** Syria, Venezuela, Afghanistan, South Sudan and Myanmar.
- **Reason of Displacement:**
 - Persecution, conflict, violence, human rights violations or events seriously disturbing public order were the main reasons behind the forced displacement.



- 80% of the world's displaced people are in countries or territories **affected by acute food insecurity and malnutrition** – many of them facing climate and other disaster risks.

World Refugee Day:

- It is an **international day designated by the United Nations** to honour refugees around the globe.
- It falls each year on **20th June** and celebrates the strength and courage of people who have been forced to flee their home country to escape conflict or persecution.
- It is an occasion to build empathy and understanding for the refugee's plight and to recognize their resilience in rebuilding their lives.

United Nations High Commissioner for Refugees:

- United Nations High Commissioner for Refugees (UNHCR) is a **UN Refugee Agency** and a global organization dedicated to saving lives, protecting the rights and building a better future for refugees, forcibly displaced communities and stateless people.
- It was **created in 1950** to help millions of Europeans who had fled or lost their homes due to World War II. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**
- It is headquartered at **Geneva, Switzerland.**

58. (a)

Explanation:

- President/governor appoints the pro-tem speaker to preside over the sittings of the newly elected house. Usually, the senior most member of the house is made the pro-tem speaker. He presides over the first sitting of the Lok Sabha, administers the oath of office to the newly elected MPs. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- President himself administers the oath to the pro-Tem speaker. **Hence, statement 2 is NOT correct.**

59. (a)

Explanation:

Committee on Private Members' Bills and Resolutions:

It classifies the bills and allocates time for the discussion of bills and resolutions introduced by private members (other than ministers).

This is a special committee of the Lok Sabha and consists of 15 members including the Deputy Speaker as its chairman. **Hence, statement 2 is NOT correct.**

The Rajya Sabha does not have such a committee. The same function in the Rajya Sabha is performed by the business advisory committee of that House. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**

60. (c)

Explanation:

- Disqualification on Ground of Defection - A member incurs disqualification under the defection law:
 - I. If he voluntarily gives up the membership of the political party on whose ticket he is elected to the House. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
 - II. If he votes or abstains from voting in the House contrary to any direction given by his political party.
 - III. If any independently elected member joins any political party.
 - IV. If any nominated member joins any political party after the expiry of six months. **Hence, statement 3 is correct.**
- The Parliament has laid down the following additional disqualifications in the Representation of People Act (1951):
 1. He must not have been found guilty of certain election offences or corrupt practices in the elections.
 2. He must not have been convicted for any offence resulting in imprisonment for two or more years. But, the detention of a person under a preventive detention law is not a disqualification.
 3. He must not have failed to lodge an account of his election expenses within the time. **Hence, statement 2 is NOT correct.**
 4. He must not have any interest in government contracts, works or services.
 5. He must not be a director or managing agent nor hold an office of profit in a corporation in which the government has at least 25 per cent share.
 6. He must not have been dismissed from government service for corruption or disloyalty to the State.
 - 7 He must not have been convicted for promoting enmity between different groups or for the offence of bribery.
 - 8 He must not have been punished for preaching and practising social crimes such as untouchability, dowry and sati.



61. (d)

Explanation:

Tholpavakoothu:

- It is a traditional temple art in Kerala having its roots in Palakkad and neighbouring regions.
 - ◆ This art is confined largely to Pulavar families from Shoranur region of Palakkad district.
- Among the ancient artforms of Kerala, tholpavakoothu or shadow puppet play occupies a prominent place. It is a fine example of the integration of Aryan and Dravidian cultures. **Hence, statement 1 is NOT correct and statement 3 is correct.**
- It is a ritual art performed during the annual festivals in the Kaali temples of Palakkad district.
 - ◆ It is also known as Nizhalkkoothu and Olakkoothu.
- The theme of the play is based on the Kamba Ramayana (the Tamil version of the epic). **Hence, statement 2 is NOT correct.**
- **Origin:**
 - In Malayalam, Thol means leather, pava means doll and koothu the play. Though the origin of this ritualistic art form is not known exactly, some believe it to be as old as 1200 years.
 - It used to be performed in the Bhadrakali temples of Palakkad, telling tales from the Ramayana.
- **The Show:**
 - This entertainment art is performed on a special stage called koothumadam in the temple courtyard.
 - It is performed using the mythological figures along with the use of fire and lighting of lamps behind the screen.
 - The chief puppeteer is known as 'Pulavan'.

62. (c)

Explanation:

Padhna Likhna Abhiyan:

- The primary objective of Padhna Likhna Abhiyan is to impart functional literacy to 57 lakh adult illiterates aged 15 and above under a Basic Literacy Programme for a period of one year - 2020 to 2021. **Hence, statements 1 and 2 are correct.**

- Adult Education in the Indian context extends the educational option to those adults, who have lost the opportunity of getting an education and transcended the age for formal education, and now feel a need for pursuing basic education, vocational education (skill development), equivalency, physical and emotional development, practical arts, applied science, or recreation.
- Currently, the percentage of adult illiterates in India is around 35% of the world's total adult illiterates.
- The Abhiyan will focus on women, Scheduled Castes (SCs), Scheduled Tribes (STs), Minorities, other disadvantaged groups and aspirational districts.

63. (b)

Explanation:

Consumer Welfare Fund (CWF):

- **About:**
 - It was set up under the Central Goods and Services Tax (CGST) Act, 2017. The consumer welfare fund rules of 1992 have been subsumed under the CGST rules, 2017. **Hence, statement 1 is NOT correct.**
 - The Fund has been set up by the **Department of Revenue (Ministry of Finance) and is being operated by the Department of Consumer Affairs (Ministry of Consumer Affairs, Food & Public Distribution).** **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**
- **Objective:** To promote and protect the welfare of the consumers. Few Examples:
 - Creation of Consumer Law Chairs/Centres of Excellence in Institutions/Universities of repute to foster research and training on consumer related issues.
 - Projects for spreading consumer literacy and awareness.
- Consumer awareness projects having wider coverage and adopting best international practices seem to have a more visible and lasting impact.
 - Hence projects with national, multi-state and pan-Indian coverage with innovative ideas will receive priority for funding from CWF. **Hence, statement 3 is NOT correct.**



64. (d)

Explanation:

Composition of Legislative Council:

- **Strength** - Unlike the members of the Legislative Assembly, the members of the Legislative Council are indirectly elected. The maximum strength of the Council is fixed at one-third of the total strength of the Assembly and the minimum strength is fixed at 40. It means that the size of the Council depends on the size of the Assembly of the concerned State. This is done to ensure the predominance of the directly elected House (Assembly) in the legislative affairs of the State. Though the Constitution has fixed the maximum and the minimum limits, the actual strength of a Council is fixed by Parliament. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- **Manner of Election** - Of the total number of members of a Legislative Council:
 - 1/3 are elected by the members of local bodies in the State like municipalities, district boards, etc.
 - 1/12 are elected by graduates of three years standing and residing within the state.
 - 1/12 are elected by teachers of three years standing in the State, not lower in standard than secondary school.
 - 1/3 are elected by the members of the Legislative Assembly of the State from amongst persons who are not members of the Assembly.
 - The remainder are nominated by the Governor from amongst persons who have special knowledge or practical experience of literature, science, art, cooperative movement, and social service.
 - ◆ Thus, 5/6 of the total number of members of a Legislative Council are indirectly elected and 1/6 are nominated by the Governor. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**
 - ◆ The members are elected in accordance with the system of proportional representation by means of a single transferable vote.

65. (d)

Explanation:

International Solar Alliance (ISA):

- ISA is a joint initiative of **India and France** launched at Conference of Parties 21 in Paris in 2015.

- International Solar Alliance (ISA) has recently launched two new initiatives – a ‘**World Solar Bank**’ and ‘**One Sun One World One Grid Initiative**’.
- The proposed World Solar Bank would **cater to the need for a dedicated financing window for solar energy projects across the members of ISA. Hence, statement 1 is NOT correct.**
- It is expected to provide **low-cost financing at favourable terms** for solar energy projects as well as engage in co-financing with other multilateral/bilateral development financial institutions.
- The ‘**One Sun One World One Grid**’ initiative aims to create an **interconnected green grid** that will enable solar energy generation in regions with high potential and facilitate its evacuation to demand centres.
- To institutionalize its partnership with the Corporate sector, the ISA Secretariat has recently launched a ‘Coalition for Sustainable Climate Action’ comprising global public and private corporates. **Hence, statement 2 is NOT correct.**
- The partner organisations under the coalition would benefit from the network and the platform provided by ISA to leverage and demonstrate their expertise in promoting sustainable development globally.

66. (d)

Explanation:

- Chilka lake occupies a unique place for its rich avifauna, both resident and migratory. Large flocks of ducks, flamingos, pelicans, teals, geese, plovers, gulls terns etc. migrate to this lake during winter to escape from adverse climatic conditions in their habitats and in search of food.
- More than 100 species of birds both resident and migratory are found at Chilka Lake. There is a good population of black buck and deer in the casuarina forests on the narrow long strip of land between the lake and the Bay of Bengal.
- **Dolphin and the rare dugong** at the mouth of the lake, spotted deer and black buck along the narrow strip of land and feral cattle are the important faunal features of the lake.
- The endangered **Irrawaddy dolphins** face threats from illegal prawn gherris.
- The first-ever survey of the **fishing cat** in and around Asia’s biggest brackish water lagoon, the Chilika lake in Odisha was conducted in March, 2021.



67. (c)

Explanation:

- **Bioplastic** refers to plastic made from plants like **maize, wheat or sugarcane or other biological material instead of petroleum. Bio-plastics are biodegradable and compostable plastic materials.**
- It can be made by extracting sugar from plants like corn and sugarcane and converting it into polylactic acids (PLA). It can also be made from polyhydroxyalkanoates (PHA) **from microorganisms. Hence, statement 2 is correct.**
- PLA plastic is commonly used in food packaging, while PHA is often used in medical devices like sutures and cardiovascular patches.
- Bioplastics, or plant-based plastics, are promoted as a climate-friendly alternative to petroleum-based plastics.
- Plastics are usually made from petroleum. They have impacts in terms of fossil fuel depletion and climate change.

Impact of Bioplastics:

- **Cropland Expansion:** Increase in use of bioplastics may trigger cropland expansion on the global scale, which will further increase greenhouse gas emissions.
- **Deforestation:** The production of bioplastics in large amounts might change land use globally. This could lead to an increase in the conversion of forest areas to arable land for agriculture. As forests absorb more carbon dioxide than maize or sugar cane field annually. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- **Food Scarcity:** Using a substance like corn for plastic instead of food may cause food constraints in an increasingly food-scarce world.
- **Industrial composting required:** Industrial composting is necessary to heat the bioplastic to a high enough temperature that allows microbes to break it down. Without that intense heat, bioplastics will not degrade on their own either in landfills or in the compost heap. If they end up in marine environments, they'll function similarly to petroleum-based plastic.
 - Thus, establishing large-scale plants for Industrial composting of bioplastics may not be economically and environmentally feasible.

68. (b)

Explanation:

Panel of Chairpersons of Lok Sabha :

- Under the Rules of Lok Sabha, the Speaker nominates from amongst the members a panel of not more than ten chairpersons. **Hence, statement 1 is NOT correct.**
- Any of them can preside over the House in the absence of the Speaker or the Deputy Speaker.
- He has the same powers as the Speaker when so presiding. He holds office until a new panel of chairpersons is nominated.
- When a member of the panel of chairpersons is also not present, any other person as determined by the House acts as the Speaker. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**
- It must be emphasised here that a member of the panel of chairpersons cannot preside over the House when the office of the Speaker or the Deputy Speaker is vacant. During such time, the Speaker's duties are to be performed by such member of the House as the President may appoint for the purpose. The elections are held, as soon as possible, to fill the vacant posts.

69. (b)

Explanation:

The Parliament can abolish a legislative council (where it already exists) or create it (where it does not exist), if the legislative assembly of the concerned state passes a resolution to that effect.

Such a resolution must be passed by the state assembly by a special majority, that is, a majority of the total membership of the assembly and a majority of not less than two-thirds of the members of the assembly present and voting.

Hence, option (b) is correct.

70. (b)

Explanation:

- The Eastern Dedicated Freight Corridor (EDFC) project is part of India's Dedicated Freight Corridor (DFC) programme, which aims to create one of the world's biggest cargo operations.
- The EDFC project involves the construction of a 1,839km-long freight line extending from Ludhiana in the Indian state of Punjab to Dankuni near Kolkata.



- The project is being implemented by Dedicated Freight Corridor Corporation of India Limited (DFCCIL), a special purpose vehicle established by the Ministry of Railways for the construction, operation and maintenance of the dedicated freight corridors.
 - DFCCIL is also responsible for planning, development, mobilisation of financial resources and operation of the DFCs.
- The main objective of the project is to support freight movement on the Eastern Corridor, which starts in **West Bengal**, and passes through the states of **Jharkhand, Bihar, Uttar Pradesh (UP) and Haryana** before finally ending at **Punjab**. Hence, option (b) is correct.
- The Eastern corridor is backed up by the World Bank, which aims to achieve integration, transformation and inclusion through the project by improving transport connectivity and domestic market integration for freight consigning industries in India.

71. (c)

Explanation:

Pagri Sambhal Movement:

- It was a successful farm agitation that forced the British government to repeal three laws related to agriculture back in 1907.
- The Punjab Land Alienation Act 1900, the Punjab Land Colonisation Act 1906 and the Doab Bari Act 1907.
- These acts would reduce farmers from owners to contractors of land, and gave the British government the right to take back the allotted land if the farmer even touched a tree in his field without permission.
- The slogan, Pagdi Sambhal Jatta, the name of the movement, was inspired by the song by Banke Lal, the editor of the Jang Sayal newspaper.
- The protests were violent and the protestors ransacked government buildings, post offices, banks, overturning telephone poles and pulling down telephone wires.
- Bhagat Singh's uncle **Ajit Singh** was the force behind this agitation. Hence, option (c) is correct.
- He wanted to channel people's anger over the farm laws to topple the colonial government.
- Bhagat Singh's father Kishan Singh and uncle Ajit Singh, with their revolutionary friend Ghasita Ram, formed **Bharat Mata Society**, aiming to mobilise this unrest into a revolt against the British government.

- Many young revolutionaries like Sufi Amba Prasad, Zia-ul-Haq, Lal Chand Falak, Din Dayal Banke, Kishan Singh and Lala Ram Saran Das were among the members of Bharat Mata Society.

72. (b)

Explanation:

Kinnal Craft:

- **Kinnal Craft or Kinhal Craft** is a traditional wooden craft local to the town of Kinhal or Kinnal in **Koppal District, Karnataka**. The craft was awarded the Geographical Indication tag in 2012. Hence, statement 2 is correct.
- **Artisans:** The traditional artisans of the craft are known as **chitragars**. They use a local variety of wood called Polki Marran which grows in and around Jabbalgudda village (near Koppal).
- **Origin:** The craft dates back to the 15th or 16th century. It is thought to have gained prominence and patronage under the Vijayanagara Empire, and later, the Nawabs of Koppal. The intricate carvings on the famous Hampi chariot are believed to be the handiwork of the Kinnal artisans. Hence, statement 1 is NOT correct.
- **Colours Used:** The craft is painted using water-colours or enamel, the signature colours of Kinnal are red, green, yellow and black.
- **Themes:** The themes are mainly mythological — idols of deities including Hanuman, Garuda, Gowri and Durga are among Kinnal's signature creations.
 - Many of the artisans are also involved in making larger idols for the local village festivals, or ooru habba, along with paraphernalia such as palanquins, cradles and chowkis.
- **Significance:** Kinhal toys also have a signature gold and silver colour which is done using a special technique called "Lajawara" method. It is prepared by hand-beating sheets of tin which results in a powder that when processed further yields silver and then gold paint. It is a very expensive and tedious process.

73. (d)

Explanation:

- The features of a Private Bill are as follows -
 - I. It is introduced by any member of Parliament other than a minister.



- II. It reflects the stand of the opposition party on public matters.
- III. It has a lesser chance to be approved by the Parliament.
- IV. Its rejection by the House has no implication on the parliamentary confidence in the government or its resignation.
- V. Its introduction in the House **requires one month's notice**.
- VI. Its drafting is the responsibility of the member concerned.

Hence, option (d) is correct.

74. (d)

Explanation:

- Articles **52 to 78** in **Part V** of the Constitution deal with the Union executive.
 - The Union executive consists of the **President**, the **Vice-President**, the **Prime Minister**, the **Council of Ministers** and the **Attorney General** of India.
 - The President is the head of the Indian State. He is the first citizen of India and acts as a symbol of unity, integrity and solidarity of the nation.
 - The President is elected not directly by the people but by members of an electoral college consisting of:
 - The elected members of both the Houses of Parliament. **Hence, statement 1 is NOT correct.**
 - The elected members of the legislative assemblies of the states; and
 - The elected members of the legislative assemblies of the Union Territories of Delhi and Puducherry.
- Hence, statement 2 is NOT correct.**

75. (c)

Exp.: Panchayats (Extension to Scheduled Areas) Act, 1996:

1. A state legislation on the Panchayats in the Scheduled Areas shall be in consonance with the customary laws, social and religious practices and traditional management practices of community resources.
2. Every panchayat at the village level shall be required to obtain from the Gram Sabha a certification of utilisation of funds for their plans, programmes and projects.

3. The reservation of seats in the Scheduled Areas in every Panchayat shall be in proportion to the population of the communities for whom reservation is sought to be given under Part IX of the Constitution. However, the reservation for the Scheduled Tribes shall not be less than one-half of the total number of seats. Further, all seats of Chairpersons of panchayats at all levels shall be reserved for the Scheduled Tribes. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
4. Planning and management of minor water bodies in the Scheduled Areas shall be entrusted to Panchayats at the appropriate level.
5. The recommendations of the Gram Sabha or the Panchayats at the appropriate level shall be mandatory for grant of prospecting licence or mining lease for minor minerals in the Scheduled Areas. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**

76. (d)

Explanation:

- 73rd Constitutional Amendment Act, 1992 has added a new Part-IX to the Constitution of India. This part is titled as 'The Panchayats' and consists of provisions from Articles 243 to 243 O.
- The act gives a constitutional status to the Panchayati Raj Institutions. It has brought them under the purview of the justiciable part of the Constitution. In other words, the state governments are under constitutional obligation to adopt the new panchayati raj system in accordance with the provisions of the act.
- All the members of Panchayats at the village, intermediate and district levels are elected directly by the people.
- The chairperson of Panchayats at the intermediate and district levels shall be elected indirectly—by and from amongst the elected members. However, the chairperson of a Panchayat at the village level are elected in such manner as the state legislature determines.
- The act provides for the reservation of seats for Scheduled Sastes and Scheduled Tribes in every panchayat (at all the three levels) in proportion of their population to the total population in the Panchayat area. Further, the state legislature shall provide for the reservation of offices of chairperson in the Panchayat at the village or any other levels for the SCs and STs.



- The act provides for the reservation of not less than one-third of the total number of seats for women (including the number of seats reserved for women belonging to the SCs and STs). Further, not less than one-third of the total number of offices of chairpersons in the Panchayats at each level shall be reserved for women.
- The act does not apply to the states of Nagaland, Meghalaya and Mizoram and certain other areas. These areas include, (a) the scheduled areas and the tribal areas in the states; (b) the hill area of Manipur for which a district council exists; and (c) Darjeeling district of West Bengal for which Darjeeling Gorkha Hill Council exists. **Hence, statement 1 is NOT correct.**
- However, the Parliament may extend the provisions of this Part to the Scheduled Areas and Tribal Areas subject to such exceptions and modifications as it may specify.
- The President of India may direct that the provisions of this act shall apply to any union territory subject to such exceptions and modifications as he may specify. **Hence, statement 2 is NOT correct.**

77. (d)

Explanation:

- The Parliament is too unwieldy a body to deliberate effectively the issues that come up before it. Therefore, it is assisted by a number of committees in the discharge of its duties.
- The Constitution of India makes a mention of these committees at different places, but without making any specific provisions regarding their composition, tenure, functions, etc. All these matters are dealt with by the rules of two Houses. Accordingly, a parliamentary committee means a committee that:
 1. Is appointed or elected by the House or nominated by the Speaker/Chairman.
 2. Works under the direction of the Speaker/Chairman.
 3. Presents its report to the House or to the Speaker/Chairman.
 4. Has a secretariat provided by the Lok Sabha/Rajya Sabha.

Hence, option (d) is correct.

- The consultative committees, which also consist of members of Parliament, are not parliamentary committees as they do not fulfil the above four conditions.

78. (a)

Explanation:

- Biofuel is the product of blending a fossil fuel with a certain percentage of ethanol. This ethanol is generally extracted from crops, oilseeds and waste, and mixed in a ratio that doesn't affect the properties of the fossil fuel while reducing the amount of greenhouse gases it emits.
- In 2008, the National BioFuel Policy (NBP) targeted an ethanol blending of 20% in both petrol and diesel by 2017.
- However, by 2017, the government had achieved only a 2% blend with petrol and about 0.1% with diesel. So it revised the policy the next year and set new targets: 20% ethanol in petrol and 5% ethanol in diesel by 2030.
- Bioethanol and biodiesel in India can be produced from various sources. Depending on the raw material, a biofuel is called 1G, 2G and 3G, where 'G' stands for 'generation'.
 - The source of 1G – the first generation of biofuels – include edible sources like molasses, sugar-containing materials like sugarcane, sugar beet and sorghum, starch-containing materials like corn, cassava and rotten potatoes, and edible oil seeds.
 - 2G biofuels use non-edible sources like non-edible oilseeds (e.g. *Jatropha curcas*), used cooking oil, agriculture residue such as rice straw, cotton stalk, corn cobs, saw dust, bagasse, etc.
 - 3G biofuels are drawn from industrial waste, municipal solid waste, etc. 2G and 3G biofuels are recognised as being more advanced. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**

Problems with Indian sugarcane:

- India produces 'C grade' canes, which yield 1 litre of biofuel from about 0.004 tonnes of molasses. This is considered low. **Hence, statement 2 is NOT correct.**
- The crop also requires copious amounts of groundwater, a resource already stressed in India. Sugarcane is also used in the alcohol and pharmaceutical industries, which already offer steadier demand and better prices.



79. (c)

Explanation:

- Shortwave radio, transmission and reception of information by means of electromagnetic waves about 10 to 80 m (33 to 262 feet) in length having frequencies of approximately 29.7 to 3.5 megahertz.
- Radio waves mainly travel in three ways namely ground, sky, and space waves, depending on the wavelength. Ground waves follow the curves of man-made and natural resources as well as land contours. Skywaves on the other hand bounces between ionosphere and earth, which makes them excellent in long-range transmission.
- Longwave radio signals travel from one point to the other over the earth's surface at a specific amount of power. In addition, they move in a straight line piercing through the ionosphere instead of bouncing off it. They, therefore, have the ability to cover wider terrain areas using less power.
- A shortwave radio signal, on the other hand, travels in curves following the earth's curvature while getting reflected by the ionosphere. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**
Shortwave signals travel long distances because they are skipped by air layers to long distances. This explains why shortwave radio signals can be received from anywhere across the world. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**

80. (b)

Explanation:

- To accelerate the startup ecosystem in India, Microsoft launched the 100X100X100 program for business to business (B2B) Software as a Service (SaaS) startups in India. **Hence, option (b) is correct.**
- A first of its kind program in India, this initiative will bring together 100 committed companies and 100 early and growth startups that have enterprise-ready solutions to offer.
- Each participating company will commit to spend \$100K over a course of 18 months on solutions provided by the SaaS startups.
- More than 50 startups are part of the program at launch. The 100×100×100 program will help enterprises fast track their digital transformation through faster adoption of SaaS solutions.

- It will aim to create a profitable domestic market for the fast growing Indian B2B SaaS startup segment by increasing their revenue and customer base.

81. (c)

Explanation:

Central Information Commission:

- The Central Information Commission was established by the Central Government in 2005 through an Official Gazette Notification under the provisions of the Right to Information Act (2005).
- The Commission consists of a Chief Information Commissioner and not more than ten Information Commissioners.
- They are appointed by the President on the recommendation of a committee consisting of the Prime Minister as Chairperson, the Leader of Opposition in the Lok Sabha and a Union Cabinet Minister nominated by the Prime Minister.
- The Chief Information Commissioner and an Information Commissioner shall hold office for such term as prescribed by the Central Government or until they attain the age of 65 years, whichever is earlier. They are not eligible for reappointment. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**

RTI Act 2005 now applicable in Jammu and Kashmir:

- Since the reorganization of the State of Jammu and Kashmir as Union territory of Ladakh, and Union Territory of Jammu and Kashmir, the CIC can now hear appeals and complaints of RTI applicants pertaining to these two regions.
- While the country had enacted the Right to Information Act in 2005, the erstwhile Jammu and Kashmir State had its own law, the Jammu and Kashmir RTI Act, 2009.
- The Jammu and Kashmir Right to Information Act 2009 and the Rules thereunder were repealed and the Right to Information Act 2005 and the Rules thereunder were enforced from October 31, 2019. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**

82. (c)

Explanation:

- **Article 371, Maharashtra and Gujarat:** Governor has “special responsibility” to establish “separate development boards” for “Vidarbha, Marathwada, and



the rest of Maharashtra”, and Saurashtra and Kutch in Gujarat; ensure “equitable allocation of funds for developmental expenditure over the said areas”, and “equitable arrangement providing adequate facilities for technical education and vocational training, and adequate opportunities for employment” under the state government.

- **Article 371A (13th Amendment Act, 1962), Nagaland:** This provision was inserted after a 16-point agreement between the Centre and the Naga People’s Convention in 1960, which led to the creation of Nagaland in 1963. Parliament cannot legislate in matters of Naga religion or social practices, Naga customary law and procedure, administration of civil and criminal justice involving decisions according to Naga customary law, and ownership and transfer of land without the concurrence of the state Assembly.
- **Article 371B (22nd Amendment Act, 1969), Assam:** The President may provide for the constitution and functions of a committee of the Assembly consisting of members elected from the state’s tribal areas.
- **Article 371C (27th Amendment Act, 1971), Manipur:** The President may provide for the constitution of a committee of elected members from the Hill areas in the Assembly, and entrust “special responsibility” to the Governor to ensure its proper functioning.
- **Article 371D (32nd Amendment Act, 1973; substituted by the Andhra Pradesh Reorganisation Act, 2014), Andhra Pradesh and Telangana:** President must ensure “equitable opportunities and facilities” in “public employment and education to people from different parts of the state”. He may require the state government to organise “any class or classes of posts in the civil service of, or any class or classes of civil posts under, the State into different local cadres for different parts of the State”. He has similar powers vis-à-vis admissions in educational institutions.
- **Article 371E:** Allows for the establishment of a university in **Andhra Pradesh** by a law of Parliament. But this is not a “special provision” in the sense of the others in this part.
- **Article 371F (36th Amendment Act, 1975), Sikkim:** The members of the Legislative Assembly of Sikkim shall elect the representative of Sikkim in the House of the People. To protect the rights and interests of various sections of the population of Sikkim, **Parliament**

may provide for the number of seats in the Assembly (not less than 30), which may be filled only by candidates from those sections. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**

- **Article 371G (53rd Amendment Act, 1986), Mizoram:** Parliament cannot make laws on “religious or social practices of the Mizos, Mizo customary law and procedure, administration of civil and criminal justice involving decisions according to Mizo customary law, ownership and transfer of land... unless the Assembly... so decides”.
- **Article 371H (55th Amendment Act, 1986), Arunachal Pradesh:** The Governor has a special responsibility with regard to law and order, and “he shall, after consulting the Council of Ministers, exercise his individual judgment as to the action to be taken”.
- **Article 371J (98th Amendment Act, 2012), Karnataka:** There is a provision for a separate development board for the Hyderabad-Karnataka region. There shall be “equitable allocation of funds for developmental expenditure over the said region”, and “equitable opportunities and facilities” for people of this region in government jobs and education. A proportion of seats in educational institutions and state government jobs in Hyderabad-Karnataka can be reserved for individuals from that region.

Note: Recently, a resolution was brought in Meghalaya Assembly seeking to bring Meghalaya under Article 371 of the Constitution to protect the interests of the tribals. The resolution was defeated in the state assembly.

Hence, statement 1 is correct.

83. (a)

Explanation:

Public Interest Litigation:

- The concept of Public Interest Litigation (PIL) originated and developed in the USA in the 1960s. The objective behind the PIL was to provide legal representation to previously unrepresented groups and interests.
- The introduction of PIL in India was facilitated by the **relaxation** of the traditional **rule of ‘locus standi’**. According to this rule, only that person whose rights are infringed alone can move the court for the remedies, whereas, the **PIL is an exception** to this traditional rule. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**



- The **Supreme Court** and **High Court** in the exercise of powers, under **Articles 32** and **226** respectively, can entertain a petition filed by any interested person in the welfare of the people who are in a disadvantaged position and thus not in a position to knock the doors of the Court.

Scope of PIL:

- In 1998, the Supreme Court formulated a set of guidelines to be followed for entertaining PIL. These guidelines were modified in 1993 and 2003. According to them, the following categories alone will ordinarily be entertained as PIL:
 1. Bonded labour matters
 2. Neglected children
 3. Non-payment of minimum wages to workers and exploitation of casual workers and complaints of violation of Labour Laws (except in individual cases)
 4. Petitions from jails complaining of harassment, for premature release and seeking release after having completed 14 years in jail, death in jail, transfer, release on personal bond, speedy trial as a fundamental right
 5. Petitions against police for refusing to register a case, harassment by police and death in police custody
 6. Petitions against atrocities on women, in particular harassment of bride, bride-burning, rape, murder, kidnapping, etc.
 7. Petitions complaining of harassment or torture of villagers by co-villagers or by police from persons belonging to Scheduled Caste and Scheduled Tribes and economically backward classes
 8. Petitions pertaining to environmental pollution, disturbance of ecological balance, drugs, food adulteration, maintenance of heritage and culture, antiques, forest and wildlife and other matters of public importance
 9. Petitions from riot-victims
 10. Family pension
- The cases falling under the following categories will not be entertained as PIL:
 1. Landlord-tenant matters.
 2. Service matter and those pertaining to pension and gratuity.

3. Complaints against Central/ State Government departments and Local Bodies except those relating to item numbers (1) to (10) above.
4. Admission to medical and other educational institution. **Hence, statement 2 is NOT correct.**
5. Petitions for early hearing of cases pending in High Courts and Subordinate Courts.

84. (b)

Explanation:

Ordinance Making Power:

- Article 123 of the Constitution empowers the President to promulgate ordinances during the recess of Parliament. These ordinances have the same force and effect as an act of Parliament but are in the nature of temporary laws.
- The ordinance-making power of President is subject to the following four limitations
 1. He can promulgate an ordinance only when both the Houses of Parliament are not in session or when either of the two Houses of Parliament is not in session.
 - (a) An ordinance made when both the Houses are in session is void. Thus, the power of the President to legislate by ordinance is not a parallel power of legislation.
 2. He can make an ordinance only when he is satisfied that the circumstances exist that render it necessary for him to take immediate action. In Cooper case, (1970), the Supreme Court held that the President's satisfaction can be questioned in a court on the grounds of malafide. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**
 3. His ordinance-making power is coextensive as regards all matters except duration, with the law-making powers of the Parliament. This has two implications:
 - (a) An ordinance can be issued only on those subjects on which the Parliament can make laws.
 - (b) An ordinance is subject to the same constitutional limitation as an act of Parliament.
 4. Every ordinance issued by the President during the recess of Parliament must be laid before both the Houses of Parliament when it reassembles. If the ordinance is approved by both the Houses, it becomes an act



- (a) An ordinance like any other legislation can be retrospective, that is, it may come into force from a backdate. It may modify or repeal any act of Parliament or another ordinance. It can alter or amend a tax law also. **However, it cannot be issued to amend the Constitution. Hence, statement 1 is NOT correct.**

85. (c)

Explanation:

United Nations High-Level Political Forum (HLPF) on Sustainable Development:

- The establishment of the United Nations High-level Political Forum on Sustainable Development (HLPF) was mandated in 2012 by the outcome document of the United Nations Conference on Sustainable Development (Rio+20), “The Future We Want”. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**
- The Forum meets annually under the auspices of the United Nations Economic and Social Council. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- The Forum’s first meeting was held on 24 September 2013. It replaced the Commission on Sustainable Development, which had met annually since 1993.
- The HLPF is the main United Nations platform on sustainable development and it has a central role in the follow-up and review of the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development the Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) at the global level.

86. (b)

Explanation:

- Over the last decades, bilateral tax agreements, concluded by nearly every nation in the world, have served to **prevent harmful double taxation and remove obstacles to cross-border trade** in goods and services, and **movements of capital, technology and persons.**
- This extensive network of bilateral and Multilateral tax agreements has given rise to treaty abuse and “treaty-shopping” arrangements.
- **Treaty shopping:** It is an attempt by a person/company to indirectly access the benefits of a tax agreement between two jurisdictions **without being a resident** of any one of those jurisdictions. **Hence, statement 1 is NOT correct.**

- **Round tripping:** Refers to money that leaves the country through various channels and makes its way back into the country often as foreign investment. This mostly involves black money and is allegedly often used for stock price manipulation.
- Taxpayers engaged in treaty shopping and other treaty abuse strategies undermine tax sovereignty by claiming treaty benefits in situations where these benefits were not intended to be granted, thereby depriving jurisdictions of tax revenues. Thus reducing the Tax-GDP ratios. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**

87. (d)

Explanation:

Global AI Action Alliance (GAIA):

- This project is part of the **World Economic Forum’s** Shaping the Future of Technology Governance: Artificial Intelligence and Machine Learning Platform. **Hence, option (d) is correct.**
- **Mission:** To harness the transformative potential of artificial intelligence (AI) by accelerating the adoption of trusted, transparent and inclusive AI systems globally.
- The GAIA is a multi-stakeholder collaboration platform designed to accelerate the development and adoption of such tools globally and in industry sectors.
- A Steering Committee consisting of top global leaders from industry, government, academia and civil society will guide the alliance.

88. (a)

Explanation:

- The Members of Parliament Local Area Development Scheme (MPLADS) was launched in 1993. Initially, the Ministry of Rural Development was the Nodal Ministry for this scheme. In October, 1994 this scheme was transferred to the Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation.
- The extant guidelines on the Scheme were revised and published in 2016. The salient features of the Scheme include:
 - The Scheme is fully funded by the Government of India under which funds are released in the form of grants-in-aid directly to the district authorities. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**



- The funds released under the Scheme are non-lapsable, i.e., the entitlement of funds not released in a particular year is carried forward to the subsequent years, subject to eligibility. The annual entitlement per MP/constituency is ₹ 5 crore.
- Under it, the role of the Members of Parliament is limited to recommend works. Thereafter, it is the responsibility of the district authority to sanction, execute and complete the works recommended within the stipulated time period.
- The elected Lok Sabha Members can recommend works in their respective constituencies. The elected members of the Rajya Sabha can recommend works anywhere in the state from which they are elected.
Hence, statement 2 is correct.
- Nominated Members of the Parliament can recommend works for implementation, anywhere in the country.
Hence, statement 3 is NOT correct.
- MPLADS works can be implemented in areas affected by natural calamities like floods, cyclone, hailstorm, avalanche, cloudburst, pest attack, landslides, tornado, earthquake, drought, tsunami, fire and biological, chemical, radiological hazards, etc.
- In order to accord special attention to the development of areas inhabited by Scheduled Castes (SCs) and Scheduled Tribes (STs), 15 per cent of MPLADS funds are to be utilized for areas inhabited by SC population and 7.5 per cent for areas inhabited by ST population.
- If an elected Member of Parliament finds the need, to contribute these funds, to a place outside that state/UT or outside the constituency within the state or both, the MP can recommend eligible works, under these Guidelines upto a maximum of ₹ 25 lakh in a financial year. Such a gesture will promote national unity, harmony, and fraternity among the people, at the grassroots level.
- The MP can spend a maximum of ₹ 20 lakh per year for giving assistance to Differently Abled Citizens for purchase of tricycles (including motorized tricycles), battery operated motorized wheelchair and artificial limbs; and aids for visually and hearing impaired

- Recently, the Government of India in the event of struggle against **Covid-19** has suspended **Member of Parliament Local Area Development Scheme** or MPLADS funds for **two years (2020 and 2021)** and directed these funds to be transferred to the **Consolidated Fund of India**.

The Government is seeking to garner around Rs 7,900 crores by suspending the MPLADS for two years.

89. (d)

Explanation:

- The state executive consists of the Governor, the Chief Minister, the Council of Ministers, and the Advocate General of the State. Thus, there is no office of Vice-Governor (in the state) like that of Vice-President at the Centre. **Hence, option (d) is correct.**
- The Constitution of India envisages the same pattern of government in the states as that for the Centre, that is, a parliamentary system. Part VI of the Constitution deals with the government in the states. Articles 153 to 167 in Part VI of the Constitution deal with the state executive.

90. (b)

Explanation:

Money Bills:

- Article 110 of the Constitution deals with the definition of Money Bills. It states that a bill is deemed to be a Money Bill if it contains '**only**' provisions dealing with all or any of the following matters:
 - The **imposition, abolition, remission, alteration or regulation** of any tax. **Hence, statement 1 is NOT correct.**
 - The regulation of the borrowing of money by the Union government.
 - If any question arises whether a bill is a Money Bill or not, the decision of the **Speaker of the Lok Sabha** is final. His decision in this regard cannot be questioned in any court of law or in either House of Parliament or even by the President. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**
- A Money Bill can **only** be introduced in the Lok Sabha and that too on the recommendation of the President.



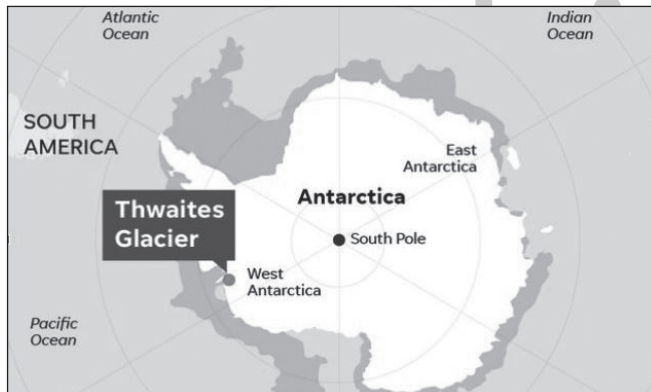
- After a Money Bill is passed by the Lok Sabha, it is transmitted to the Rajya Sabha for its consideration. The Rajya Sabha has restricted powers with regard to a Money Bill. It cannot reject or amend a Money Bill. It can only make the recommendations. It must return the bill to the Lok Sabha within **14 days**, with or without recommendations. The Lok Sabha can either accept or reject all or any of the recommendations of the Rajya Sabha.
- If the Rajya Sabha does not return the bill to the Lok Sabha within 14 days, the bill is deemed to have been passed by both Houses in the form originally passed by the Lok Sabha. **Finally**, when a **Money Bill is presented to the President**, he may either give his assent to the bill or withhold his assent to the bill but cannot return the bill for reconsideration of the Houses. Normally, the President gives his assent to a Money Bill as it is introduced in the Parliament with his prior permission. **Hence, statement 3 is correct.**

91. (b)

Explanation:

- Recently, a new study has detected the presence of warm water at a vital point beneath the Thwaites glacier as the cause of its melting.

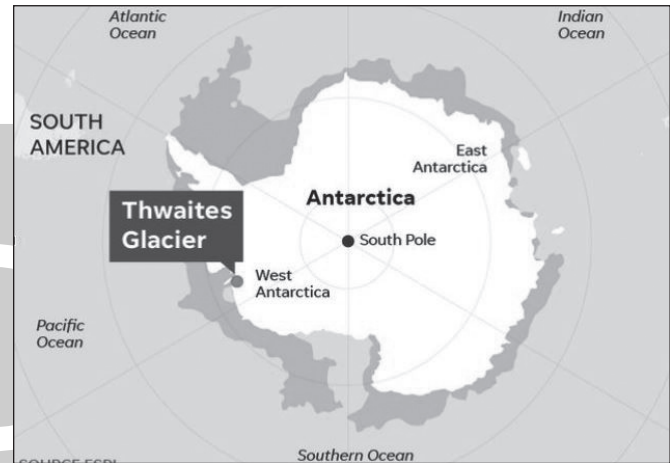
Key Points:



- The study has observed that the temperature of the water at the grounding zone or grounding line of the glacier is two degrees higher than the freezing point of the water.
 - The grounding line is the place below a glacier at which the ice transitions between resting fully on bedrock and floating on the ocean as an ice shelf.

- The location of the line is a pointer to the rate of retreat of a glacier.
- When glaciers melt and lose weight, they float off the land where they used to be situated. It makes a retreat of the grounding line.
- That exposes more of a glacier's underside to seawater, increasing the likelihood it will melt faster. This results in the glacier speeding up, stretching out, and thinning, causing the grounding line to retreat ever further.

Thwaites Glacier:



- Thwaites Glacier is 120 km wide, fast-moving glacier located in Antarctica.
- Because of its size (1.9 lakh square km), **it contains enough water to raise the world sea level by more than half a metre. Hence, option (b) is correct.**
- Its melting already contributes 4% to global sea-level rise each year. It is estimated that it would collapse into the sea in 200-900 years.
 - Studies have found the amount of ice flowing out of it has nearly doubled over the past 30 years.
- It is important for Antarctica as it slows the ice behind it from freely flowing into the ocean. Because of the risk it poses – Thwaites is often called the Doomsday Glacier.

92. (c)

Explanation:

Matua Community:

- Matuas are an influential lower caste Hindu community which had mostly migrated from East Pakistan (Bangladesh) to settle in West Bengal. **Hence, option (c) is correct.**



- In the beginning Matua-mahasangha followed simplified rituals, **but later adopted Vaishnavism.**
- It was founded in the mid-1800s by Harichand Thakur, at Gopalganj in the Faridpur province of present-day Bangladesh. He preached love, tolerance, gender equality and non-distinction irrespective of caste, class and creed.

93. (c)

Explanation:

Bare Necessities Index

- Bare Necessities Index (BNI) has been constructed at the **rural, urban and all India level** for the year 2012 and 2018. (Except Telangana, as Telangana did not exist in 2012).
- The index is constructed using 26 indicators on five dimensions viz., water, sanitation, housing, micro-environment, and other facilities.
- A BNI based on large annual household survey data of the National Sample Office (NSO).

Details of Indicators (all in percent of Households) Used under Five Dimensions given in the NSO report	
Five Dimensions	Indicators used for the analysis
Water	It has been measured using indicators like the principal source of drinking water, distance to the source of drinking water, Method of taking water and the nature of access.
Sanitation	It has been measured through indicators like access of the household to latrine and type of latrine used by the household: piped sewer system, septic tank, twin leach pit, single pit.
Housing	It has been measured through indicators like Condition of structure, types of dwelling (independent, flat or others) and puccah or kutch house
Micro-Environment	It is measured through indicators like the Drainage system of the household, whether the household faced the problem of flies/ mosquitoes during the last one year and if any effort was made by the Local Bodies/ State Government to tackle mosquitoes.

Other Facilities

The other facilities include Kitchen type (with water tap or no separate kitchen), Ventilation of the dwelling unit, Type of bathroom used by the household, **Whether the household has electricity for domestic use and electric wiring**, Type of fuel used by the household for cooking.

Bare Necessities Index (BNI) (All India Level)

- Access to bare necessities in 2018 is the **highest in the States such as Kerala, Punjab, Haryana, Gujarat, Uttarakhand, Delhi, Goa, Mizoram and Sikkim** while it is the lowest in **Odisha, Jharkhand, West Bengal and Tripura. Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- The states showing improvement on the access to bare necessities, were red in 2012 became yellow or green in 2018 or were yellow in 2012 became green in 2018, are Haryana, Punjab, Uttarakhand, Gujarat, Kerala, Rajasthan, Uttar Pradesh, Bihar, Madhya Pradesh, Chhattisgarh, and North-East states except for Tripura, Nagaland and Meghalaya.

Bare Necessities Index (BNI) (All India Level)

- **In rural India, the highest access to bare necessities in 2018 is recorded in Punjab, Kerala, Sikkim, Goa and Delhi**, while the lowest in Uttar Pradesh, Madhya Pradesh, Bihar, Jharkhand, West Bengal, Odisha, Assam, Manipur and Tripura. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**
- The States showing improvement in their access to bare necessities are J&K, Punjab, Rajasthan, Gujarat, Maharashtra, Karnataka, Chhattisgarh, Tamil Nadu, Andhra Pradesh, Kerala, Goa, Meghalaya and Arunachal Pradesh.

94. (c)

Explanation:

Cyclicity of the Fiscal Policy:

- Cyclicity of the fiscal policy refers to a change in direction of government expenditure and taxes based on economic conditions.
- These pertain to decisions by policymakers based on the fluctuations in economic growth. There are two types of cyclical fiscal policies - **counter-cyclical and procyclical.**

Pro-cyclical Fiscal Policy Stance:

- In a pro-cyclical fiscal policy, the government reinforces the business cycle by being expansionary during good times and contractionary during recessions.



- Pursuing a pro-cyclical fiscal policy is generally regarded as dangerous. It could raise macroeconomic volatility, depress investment in real and human capital, hamper growth and harm the poor.
- **In Recession:**
 - The government takes the route of **Expansionary Fiscal Policy** i.e. the government expenditure is decreased and taxes are increased. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
 - This decreases the consumption potential of the economy and deepens the recession. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**
- **In Economic Boom:**
 - The government takes the route of **contractionary Fiscal Policy** i.e. the government expenditure is increased and taxes are decreased.
 - This increases the consumption potential of the economy and helps amplify the boom.

Fiscal policy (FP) stance	Recession (↓ GDP)	Expansion (↑ GDP)	Outcome
Pro-cyclical	Contractionary FP ↓ Govt. Expenditure or /and ↑ Taxes	Expansionary FP ↑ Govt. Expenditure or /and ↓ Taxes	Deepens recessions and amplifies expansions, thereby increasing fluctuations in the business cycle.
Counter-cyclical	Expansionary FP ↑ Govt. Expenditure or /and ↓ Taxes	Contractionary FP ↓ Govt. Expenditure or /and ↑ Taxes	Softens the recession and moderates the expansions, thereby decreasing fluctuations in the business cycle.

95. (d)

Explanation:

India VIX:

- It stands for **India Volatility Index**.
- The Volatility Index is a measure of the market's expectation of volatility over the near term.
- Volatility Index is a measure of the amount by which an underlying Index is expected to fluctuate, in the near term.
- India VIX is a volatility index computed by the **National Stock Exchange (NSE) based on the NIFTY Options**. **Hence, statement 2 is NOT correct.**
- It is an index circulated by the NSE. NSE started the India VIX in 2008. **Hence, statement 1 is NOT correct.**

96. (c)

Explanation:

Scheduled Castes and Tribes

(Prevention of Atrocities) Act, 1989:

- It is an Act to prevent the commission of offences of

atrocities against SC/STs by persons other than SC/ST against SC/ST. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**

- The Act identifies what acts constitute "atrocities." All offences listed in the Act are cognizable.
- The Act calls upon all the states to convert an existing sessions court in each district into a Special Court to try cases registered under it. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- The Act creates provisions for states to declare areas with high levels of caste violence to be "atrocities-prone".
- The Act provides for the punishment for wilful neglect of duties by non-SC/ST public servants.
- The Acts designates for each District a Court of Session as a Special Court for speedy trial of offences under the Act.
- The Act provides for the appointment of Public Prosecutors/Special Public Prosecutors for conducting cases in special courts.
- The Act is implemented by the respective State Governments and Union Territory Administrations, which are provided due central assistance under the Centrally Sponsored Scheme for effective implementation of the provisions of the Act.

97. (a)

Explanation:

Lok Adalats:

- The Lok Adalat is a forum where the cases (or disputes) which are pending in a court or which are at pre-litigation stage (not yet brought before a court) are compromised or settled in an amicable manner. **Hence, statement 2 is NOT correct.**
- It is one of the components of ADR (Alternative Dispute Resolution) system
- The institution of Lok Adalat has been given statutory status under the Legal Services Authorities Act, 1987.
- The Act makes the following provisions relating to the organisation and functioning of the Lok Adalats:
 1. The State Legal Services Authority or the District Legal Services Authority or the Supreme Court Legal Services Committee or the High Court Legal Services Committee or the Taluk Legal Services Committee may organise Lok Adalats at such intervals and places and for exercising such jurisdiction and for such areas as it thinks fit.
 2. Every Lok Adalat organised for an area shall consist of such number of serving or retired judicial officers and other persons of the area as may be specified by the agency organizing such Lok Adalat.



3. A Lok Adalat shall have jurisdiction to determine and to arrive at a compromise or settlement between the parties to a dispute in respect of:
 - (a) any case pending before any court; or
 - (b) any matter which is falling within the jurisdiction of any court and not brought before such court.
4. The Lok Adalat shall have the same powers as are vested in a Civil Court under the Code of Civil Procedure (1908),
5. An award of a Lok Adalat shall be deemed to be a decree of a Civil Court or an order of any other court. Every award made by a Lok Adalat shall be final and binding on all the parties to the dispute. **No appeal shall lie to any court against the award of the Lok Adalat. Hence, statement 1 is correct.**

98. (c)

Explanation:

National Disaster Management Authority:

- However, after the Indian Ocean tsunami of 2004, the Government of India enacted the Disaster Management Act, 2005. The Act provided for the creation of the National Disaster Management Authority (NDMA).
- The NDMA consists of a chairperson and other members, not exceeding nine. The Prime Minister is the ex-officio chairperson of the NDMA. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- The other members are nominated by the chairperson of the NDMA. The chairperson of the NDMA designates one of the members as the vice-chairperson of the NDMA.
- The vice-chairperson has the status of a Cabinet Minister while the other members have the status of a Minister of State.
- The NDMA is the apex body for disaster management in the country. It works under the administrative control of the Union Ministry of Home Affairs. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**

99. (a)

Explanation:

Cooperative Societies:

The 97th Constitutional Amendment Act of 2011 gave constitutional status and protection to co-operative societies. In this context, it made the following three changes in the constitution:

1. It made the right to form co-operative societies a fundamental right (Article 19). **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
2. It included a new Directive Principle of State Policy on the promotion of co-operative societies (Article 43-B2).

3. It added a new Part IX-B in the Constitution which is entitled "The Co-operative Societies" (Articles 243-ZH to 243-ZT).

- The "co-operative societies" is a subject enumerated in Entry 32 of the state list of the Seventh Schedule of the Constitution. **Hence, statement 2 is NOT correct.**
- **Incorporation of Co-operative Societies:** The state legislature may make provisions for the incorporation, regulation and winding-up of co-operative societies based on the principles of voluntary formation, democratic member control, member economic participation and autonomous functioning.

100. (d)

Explanation:

Special Provisions For Delhi:

- The 69th Constitutional Amendment Act of 1991 provided a special status to the Union Territory of Delhi, and redesignated it the National Capital Territory of Delhi and designated the administrator of Delhi as the **Lieutenant (Lt.) Governor**.
- It created a **legislative assembly and a council of ministers for Delhi**.
- The **strength of the assembly** is fixed at **70 members**, directly elected by the people.
- The assembly can make laws on all the matters of the **State List and the Concurrent List** except the three matters of the State List, that is, **public order, police and land**. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**
- The strength of the council of ministers is fixed at **ten percent** of the total strength of the assembly, that is, **seven—one chief minister and six other ministers**.
- The **chief minister is appointed by the President** (not by the Lt. governor). **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- The other ministers are appointed by the president on the advice of the chief minister.
- In case of failure of constitutional machinery, the president can impose his rule in the territory. This can be done on the report of the Lt. governor or otherwise.
- The **lieutenant governor is empowered to promulgate ordinances** during recess of the assembly. An ordinance has the same force as an act of the assembly. **Hence, statement 3 is correct.**
- Every such ordinance must be approved by the assembly within six weeks from its reassembly. He can also withdraw an ordinance at any time. But, he cannot promulgate an ordinance when the assembly is dissolved or suspended. Further, no such ordinance can be promulgated or withdrawn without the prior permission of the President.

